MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

OFFICIAL OFQUAL SPECIFICATION

LEVEL 1 & E3

CORE REVISION GUIDE • MODEL ANSWERS

DIGITAL

DIGITAL SKILLS

PRACTICAL HANDBOOK

EDSQ Complete Standards & Workplace Skills

Using Devices | Creating Media | Communicating | Online Safety

PEARSON EDEXCEL & CITY & GUILDS ALIGNED

2026/2027 EDITION

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS • COMPLETE TABLE OF CONTENTS • PART 1

Essential Digital Skills • EDSQ

CONTENTS

Comprehensive National Standards Handbook • The 5 Statutory Domains & Units 1 to 10

FM.1	Hardware, Operating Systems & Cloud Storage Architecture	p.4
FM.2	National Curriculum Diagnostic Skills Audit & Self-Assessment	p.5
FM.3	The 5 Statutory DfE Skill Areas & Examination Blueprint	p.6
FM.4	Learner Competency Milestone Tracker & Target Log	p.7
Unit 1	Operating Systems, File Hierarchy & Cloud Storage (Domain 1)	p.8
Unit 2	Advanced Search Syntax & Information Verification (Domain 1)	p.12
Unit 3	Professional Word Processing & Structured Documents (Domain 2)	p.16
Unit 4	Spreadsheet Modeling, Formulas & Functions (Domain 2)	p.20
Unit 5	Presentation Design, Multimedia & Visual Slides (Domain 2)	p.24
Unit 6	Professional Email Etiquette, CC/BCC & Data Privacy (Domain 3)	p.28
Unit 7	Video Conferencing, Screen Sharing & Online Collaboration (Domain 3)	p.32
Unit 8	E-Commerce Navigation, Secure Payments & Online Shopping (Domain 4)	p.36
Unit 9	Public Digital Services, GOV.UK Portals & Online Forms (Domain 4)	p.40
Unit 10	Cybersecurity, Passwords, MFA & UK GDPR Compliance (Domain 5)	p.44

Master Functional Skills • Essential Digital Skills (EDSQ) • Complete Course Guide **Lead Tutor:** Abdul • **Edition:** 2026/2027 Reformed Standards

• Continued on Page 3

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS • COMPLETE TABLE OF CONTENTS • PART 2

Essential Digital Skills • EDSQ

Workplace Scenario Mock Exams, Advanced Software Labs & Technical Reference Directory

CONTENTS

Mock 1	Medical Practice Portal & Patient Records Administration	p.48
Mock 2	Community Food Bank Logistics & Stock Tracking Spreadsheet	p.52
Mock 3	Apprentice Training Hub & E-Learning Administration	p.56
Mock 4	Digital Library Archive & Asset Loan Management	p.60
Lab 1	Cloud Storage Architecture & Access Permissions (View, Edit, Manage)	p.64
Lab 2	Advanced Spreadsheet Modeling & Data Validation Dropdowns	p.66
Lab 3	Professional Business Correspondence, Dispute Letters & Invites	p.68
Lab 4	Cybersecurity Vulnerability Triage & Phishing Incident Logging	p.70
Lab 5	Corporate Document Processing, Alt-Text & Accessible PDF Tagging	p.72
Lab 6	Online Research, Source Reliability (CRAAP Test) & Copyright	p.74
IT.REF1	Workplace File Format, Compression & Extension Directory	p.76
IT.REF2	Spreadsheet Error Diagnostics (#VALUE!, #REF!) & Function Syntax	p.77
IT.REF3	Cybersecurity Incident Escalation & 72-Hour GDPR Flowchart	p.78
IT.REF4	Workplace Digital Security Hygiene & 20-20-20 Ergonomics Audit	p.79
REF.1	Comprehensive Worked Solutions: Units 1 to 10 Practical Drills	p.80
REF.2	Comprehensive Worked Solutions: Practical Mock Exams 1 to 4	p.82
REF.3	Universal Operating System Shortcuts, Glossary & Curriculum Index	p.83
CP	Digital Skills Competency Passport (National Standards Sign-Off)	p.86
CERT	Master Functional Skills Official Certificate of Digital Competence	p.87

Master Functional Skills • Essential Digital Skills (EDSQ) • Practical Mocks, Labs & Solutions

Foundation Course Begins on Page 4 • Lead Tutor: Abdul

EDSQ FOUNDATION KNOWLEDGE

HW Hardware, OS & Cloud Architecture



Modern workplace computing: high-performance hardware, multi-screen workstations, and cloud sync.

Essential Computing Infrastructure • Plain English Core Guide

Operating System (OS): The master software running your computer or phone (Windows, macOS, ChromeOS, Android). It manages your hardware, runs programs like Word or browsers, and provides accessibility settings (screen zoom, high contrast).

Cloud Storage & Syncing: Storing files on secure internet servers (OneDrive, Google Drive, iCloud) so files automatically update across all your devices and are safe from theft or hardware failure.

Network & Wi-Fi Security: Connecting to the internet safely using password-protected private Wi-Fi (WPA2/WPA3). Never do online banking or enter credentials on unencrypted public Wi-Fi.

File Hierarchy & Folders: Organising work into nested folders and subfolders (like dividers in a filing cabinet). Standard file extensions (.docx, .xlsx, .pdf, .jpg) tell your device which program opens the file.

Input & Output Hardware: Input devices (keyboard, mouse, webcam, microphone) send information into the computer; output devices (monitors, printers, speakers) present information to you.

Accessibility Tools: Built-in features like screen magnifiers, text-to-speech readers, speech-to-text dictation, and dyslexia color filters that make computers usable for everyone.

Security Golden Rule

Always check the file extension before opening email attachments (.exe, .bat, or .scr often signify dangerous malware).

Workplace Trap!

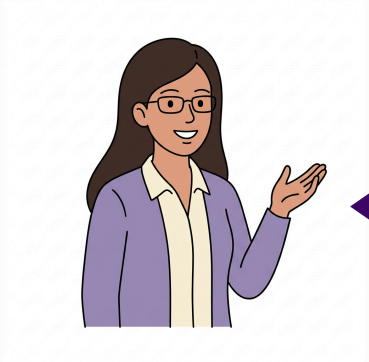
Remember to lock your workstation screen (Win + L) whenever you step away from your desk to protect confidential data.

SELF-ASSESSMENT & SKILLS AUDIT

AU National Curriculum Baseline Audit

DfE Essential Digital Skills Diagnostic Matrix

Skill Area	Core Workplace Competency • Plain English Description	Rating
1. Devices & Handling Info	Turn devices on, create folders, save work to cloud storage, search effectively, and adjust screen settings.	[ ] / 5
2. Creating & Editing	Write letters in Word using Styles, build spreadsheets with formulas (=SUM, =AVERAGE), and design slides.	[ ] / 5
3. Communicating	Send polite workplace emails, use To, CC, and BCC correctly for privacy, and join video conference calls.	[ ] / 5
4. Transacting	Shop online safely, verify HTTPS and SSL padlock security, complete online forms, and access GOV.UK services.	[ ] / 5
5. Being Safe & Responsible	Spot fake phishing emails, create strong passphrases (3 random words), use MFA, and protect personal data.	[ ] / 5



Priya

Score yourself honestly from 1 to 5 on each area! Any skill rated 3 or below will receive targeted practice in our units and labs.

✎ Priority Digital Skills to Upgrade in this Course

PEARSON EDEXCEL EDSQ ASSESSMENT STRUCTURE

National Standards & Examination Blueprint



Digital Functional Skills qualifications prepare adult learners for accredited workplace competence.

EDSQ Qualification Specifications • Plain English Overview

Component 1 • Knowledge Test (20%): Online multiple-choice and scenario questions covering cybersecurity, phishing identification, online safety, UK GDPR rules, and basic device settings.

Component 2 • Practical Tasks (80%): Hands-on computer-based workplace tasks requiring you to organise folders, build a spreadsheet with formulas, draft an email, or format a document.

Pass Mark Benchmark: Typically 65–70% across practical scenario tasks. Complete all tasks methodically to ensure maximum marks.

Supported Software: Standard workplace office software (Microsoft Office 365, Google Docs/Sheets, or modern web browsers).

Crucial Exam Protocol: Saving Your Work

Examiners cannot grade work that is not saved! Always save your files to the designated exam folder with the correct filename requested (e.g. `CandidateName_Task1_Budget.xlsx`) every 5 minutes (Ctrl + S).

My Practical Exam Software & Shortcut Strategy

TR

UNIT & MOCK MASTERY LOG

Digital Skills Progress Tracker

Learner Competency Milestone Tracker

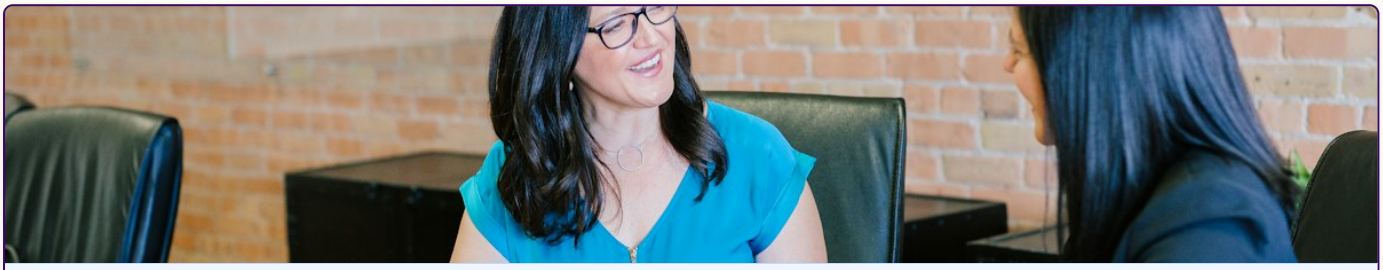
Unit / Mock Paper	Domain	Practical Score	Knowledge Check	Date
Unit 1: Operating Systems, File Hierar...	Domain 1: Us	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 2: Advanced Search Syntax & Infor...	Domain 1: Us	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 3: Professional Word Processing &...	Domain 2: Cr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 4: Spreadsheet Modeling, Formulas...	Domain 2: Cr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 5: Presentation Design, Multimedi...	Domain 2: Cr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 6: Professional Email Etiquette, ...	Domain 3: Co	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 7: Video Conferencing, Screen Sha...	Domain 3: Co	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 8: E-Commerce Navigation, Secure ...	Domain 4: Tr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 9: Digital Public Services & Offi...	Domain 4: Tr	/10	[ ] Pass	
Unit 10: Cybersecurity, Passwords, MFA ...	Domain 5: Be	/10	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 1: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 2: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 3: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	
Mock Exam 4: Scenario Simulation	Synoptic	/50	[ ] Pass	

✎ Tutor Coaching Feedback & IT Target Settings

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 1: USING DEVICES & HANDLING INFORMATION

D1.1

Unit 1 • Operating Systems, File Hierarchy & Cloud Storage



Domain 1: Structured folder hierarchies, file naming conventions, and cloud storage.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Operating System (OS): The **operating system** is the main master program that makes your computer, tablet, or smartphone work. Examples include **Windows** on PCs, **macOS** on Apple Macs, **ChromeOS** on Chromebooks, and **Android or iOS** on mobile phones. *What it does:* The OS is like the manager of your device. It lets your screen, keyboard, and mouse communicate with your software (like Word or web browsers), and lets you adjust essential settings such as screen brightness, volume, Wi-Fi connections, and accessibility tools (like screen zoom and high contrast).

File Hierarchy & Folders: A **file hierarchy** means organising your computer files into main folders and subfolders, just like placing paper documents into labelled dividers inside a filing cabinet drawer. *Example:* Instead of dumping all your files on the Desktop, create a main folder called `Documents`, a subfolder called `Customers`, and inside that a folder called `Invoices`. This stops your computer getting cluttered and helps you find documents in seconds.

File Extensions & Naming: A **file extension** is the short code after the dot at the end of a file name that tells the computer what type of file it is. Common extensions include: `.docx` for Word documents, `.xlsx` for Excel spreadsheets, `.pdf` for read-only documents that look identical on all screens, and `.jpg` or `.png` for photos. Always use clear file names with dates and version numbers (e.g. `2026-10-25_Staff_Rota_v2.docx`).

Cloud Storage & Syncing: Cloud storage means saving your files on secure internet servers (such as **Microsoft OneDrive**, **Google Drive**, or **iCloud**) rather than only on your physical computer hard drive. **Synchronization (syncing)** automatically updates your files across all your devices. *Example:* If you start an assignment at college or work, it syncs to the cloud so you can open and edit the exact same document at home on your tablet or phone. Cloud storage also protects your work if your laptop is lost, damaged, or stolen.

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Operating Systems, File Hierarchy & Cloud Storage** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D1.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • OPERATING SYSTEMS, FILE HIERARCHY & CLOUD STORAGE

Unit 1 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Open your file manager (File Explorer on Windows or Finder on Mac) to view your drives.
Step 2:	Create a main folder with a clear, professional name (e.g. `2026_Customer_Service`).
Step 3:	Inside that folder, create labelled subfolders (e.g. `01_Forms`, `02_Drafts`, `03_Final_PDFs`).
Step 4:	Save your work into the correct subfolder with a descriptive file name, date, and version.
Step 5:	Check your cloud sync icon: a green tick means your file is backed up and synced to the cloud.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Saving multiple files named 'doc1.docx', 'homework.xlsx', or 'final_real_version.docx'. You lose marks for vague file names! Always use clear descriptions with dates and version numbers (e.g. 'Clinic_Budget_2026_v1.xlsx').

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D1.1

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 1 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 1

Scenario: You are working as an administrative assistant at a local health clinic. You need to store patient feedback forms, staff meeting minutes, and quarterly budget spreadsheets. Design a 3-tier folder structure, suggest clear names for 3 files, and explain why saving all your work on the Desktop creates serious security and organisation risks.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D1.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 1 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Saving multiple files named 'doc1.docx', 'homework.xlsx', or 'final_real_version.docx'. You lose marks for vague file names! Always use clear descriptions with dates and version numbers (e.g. 'Clinic_Budget_2026_v1.xlsx').
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 1 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which file format ensures a document looks identical on all devices and cannot be easily altered?
[ ] A) .docx [ ] B) .pdf [ ] C) .txt [ ] D) .csv

2. What does the 'v2' in the file name 'Report_2026_v2.docx' stand for?
[ ] A) Volume 2 [ ] B) Version 2 [ ] C) View 2 [ ] D) Verified 2

3. What is the primary benefit of Cloud Storage (such as OneDrive or Google Drive)?
[ ] A) It speeds up your keyboard [ ] B) Files are backed up safely online and accessible from any device [ ] C) It deletes old files automatically [ ] D) It removes all computer viruses

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 1: USING DEVICES & HANDLING INFORMATION

D1.2

Unit 2 • Advanced Search Syntax & Information Verification



Domain 1: Advanced search operators (AND, OR, quotes), source evaluation, and fact-checking.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Search Engines & Search Operators: When you search for information online (using Google, Bing, or DuckDuckGo), typing whole conversational sentences often brings up millions of irrelevant results or advertisements. **Search operators** are special words and symbols you type into the search box to filter your results with precision:

- **Quotation Marks (" ... "):** Searches for the exact words together in that precise order. *Example:* `"national minimum wage rates"` finds only pages with that exact phrase.
- **Minus Sign (-):** Removes unwanted words from your search. *Example:* `jaguar speed -car` finds how fast the wild animal runs and filters out car adverts.
- **Site Search (site:):** Limits results to one specific website or domain type. *Example:* `apprenticeship funding site:.gov.uk` searches only official UK government web pages.
- **Filetype (filetype:):** Finds specific file formats. *Example:* `health and safety policy filetype:pdf` searches only downloadable PDF guides.

The CRAAP Test (Evaluating Sources): Not everything on the internet is accurate, truthful, or up to date. In education and employment, you must check sources using the 5-step **CRAAP test**:

- **C • Currency:** When was the page published or updated? (Is the information still current, or has the law changed?)
- **R • Relevance:** Does the information directly answer your workplace question?
- **A • Authority:** Who wrote it? Is the author an expert, an official organisation (like GOV.UK or the NHS), or an unverified social media account?
- **A • Accuracy:** Are the facts supported by evidence, official data, or links to primary sources?
- **P • Purpose:** Why does this page exist? Is it to inform and educate you, or is it trying to sell you a product, collect your data, or push a biased opinion?

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Advanced Search Syntax & Information Verification** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D1.2

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • ADVANCED SEARCH SYNTAX & INFORMATION VERIFICATION

Unit 2 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Decide on the exact topic and key terms you need before you start typing.
Step 2:	Use quotation marks around key phrases (e.g. `"statutory sick pay"`) to eliminate irrelevant results.
Step 3:	Add domain filters like `site:.gov.uk` or `site:.nhs.uk` to find official, trustworthy information.
Step 4:	Skip the first few results marked 'Sponsored' or 'Ad'—these are paid commercial adverts, not official guidance.
Step 5:	Compare information across at least two independent, reliable websites before quoting facts in your work.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Quoting commercial sales websites (.com) or marketing blogs as official evidence in an exam. For legal, employment, or medical questions, always rely on verified public sector sources (.gov.uk or .nhs.uk)!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D1.2

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 2 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 2

Scenario: A colleague tells you that a viral social media video claims the UK legal minimum wage for apprentices is increasing to £15 per hour next month. Write an exact search query using operators to verify this, state which domain type (.com, .gov.uk, or .org) is most authoritative, and explain two reasons why social media claims should never be trusted without verification.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D1.2

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 2 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Quoting commercial sales websites (.com) or marketing blogs as official evidence in an exam. For legal, employment, or medical questions, always rely on verified public sector sources (.gov.uk or .nhs.uk)!
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 2 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. What happens when you put quotation marks around search words (e.g. "maternity leave rights")?
[ ] A) The words are translated into French [ ] B) The search engine searches only for that exact phrase in that order [ ] C) The search engine ignores those words [ ] D) It turns off your search history

2. Which web address domain is the most trustworthy source for UK government legislation?
[ ] A) .com [ ] B) .gov.uk [ ] C) .net [ ] D) .biz

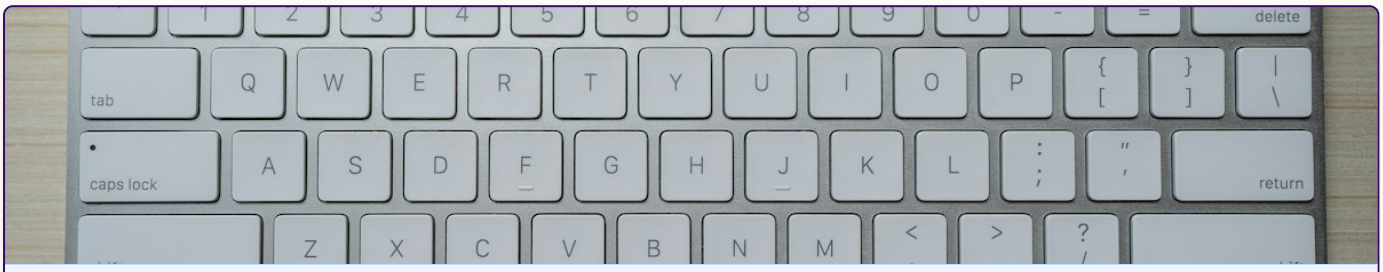
3. In the CRAAP evaluation test, what does the 'C' stand for?
[ ] A) Computer [ ] B) Currency (how up to date the information is) [ ] C) Copyright [ ] D) Cookies

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 2: CREATING & EDITING

D2.1

Unit 3 • Professional Word Processing & Structured Documents



Domain 2: Typographic hierarchy, styles, table formatting, and professional document proofreading.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Word Processing Basics: Applications like **Microsoft Word** and **Google Docs** are used to create letters, reports, memos, and leaflets. To look professional, your documents need a clear layout, consistent fonts, and tidy margins.

Paragraph Styles (Heading 1, Heading 2 & Normal): Rather than highlighting titles and manually making them bigger or bold, you should click the pre-set **Styles** on the toolbar ribbon. *Definition:* Styles are pre-set text formatting rules that keep titles, subtitles, and paragraphs looking uniform throughout your whole document.
Three Major Benefits:
1. **Consistency:** If you change font themes, every title in your 20-page document updates in one click.
2. **Accessibility:** Screen-reading software used by visually impaired colleagues uses heading styles (H1, H2) to help them navigate between chapters.
3. **Automatic Table of Contents:** Word uses your Heading 1 and Heading 2 styles to create an automated table of contents with correct page numbers instantly!

Page Layout, Spacing & Page Breaks:
• **Page Breaks (`Ctrl + Enter`):** A command that neatly starts a new page. *Golden Rule:* Never press 'Enter' 20 times to reach the next page! If you add or delete words later, all your paragraphs will shift out of position.
• **Line Spacing & Alignment:** Keep body text left-aligned with 1.15 or 1.5 line spacing. Avoid 'justified' alignment, which creates irregular white spaces between words that are difficult for people with dyslexia to read.
• **Alt-Text (Alternative Text):** A short written description added to a photo or chart (e.g. right-click image → Edit Alt-Text). A screen reader reads this aloud to visually impaired readers so they know what the image shows.

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Professional Word Processing & Structured Documents** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • PROFESSIONAL WORD PROCESSING & STRUCTURED DOCUMENTS

D2.1

Unit 3 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Set standard margins (Normal: 2.54 cm) and choose an accessible, clean font (e.g. Arial, Calibri, or Lexend at 11pt or 12pt).
Step 2:	Type your document title and click 'Title' style. Apply 'Heading 1' to main sections and 'Heading 2' to subsections.
Step 3:	Use `Ctrl + Enter` to insert a clean Page Break whenever beginning a major new topic.
Step 4:	Insert tables using `Insert → Table`, setting a clear bold header row and right-aligning numerical figures.
Step 5:	Right-click every image, select 'View Alt Text', and write a concise 1-sentence description.
Step 6:	Run the built-in Accessibility Checker (`Review → Check Accessibility`) before saving as a PDF.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Pressing the 'Enter' key repeatedly to push text onto a fresh page. In exams and the workplace, this causes messy page breaks if text is edited. Always insert a proper Page Break (`Ctrl + Enter`)!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D2.1

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 3 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 3

Scenario: You are formatting a 3-page Employee Health and Safety handbook for a community care home. Explain the font choices and heading styles you will use, state two reasons why using built-in Styles is better than manual formatting, and write suitable Alt-Text for an image showing a clearly marked emergency fire exit route.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D2.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 3 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Pressing the 'Enter' key repeatedly to push text onto a fresh page. In exams and the workplace, this causes messy page breaks if text is edited. Always insert a proper Page Break (`Ctrl + Enter`)!
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 3 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. What is the keyboard shortcut to insert a clean Page Break in Microsoft Word?
[ ] A) Shift + Tab [ ] B) Ctrl + Enter [ ] C) Alt + F4 [ ] D) Ctrl + P

2. Why is left-aligned text recommended over justified text for general readability?
[ ] A) Justified text takes up more ink [ ] B) Left-aligned text has even spacing between words, making it easier for dyslexic readers [ ] C) Left-aligned text deletes empty lines [ ] D) Justified text cannot be printed

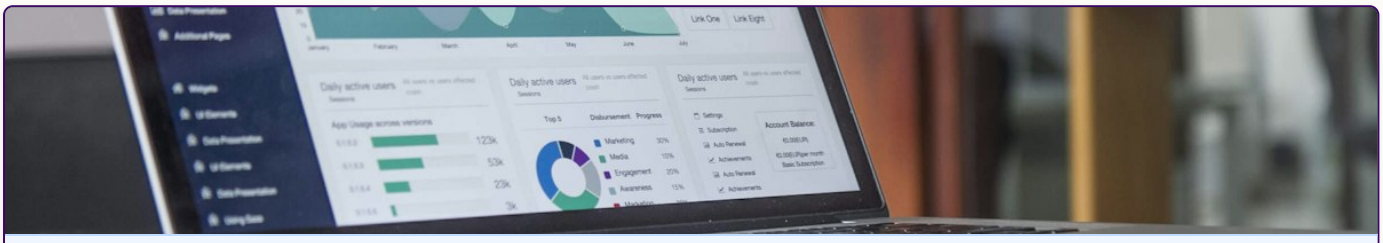
3. What is the main purpose of adding 'Alt-Text' to an image in a report?
[ ] A) It changes the image colours [ ] B) It allows screen readers to describe the image to visually impaired readers [ ] C) It compresses the image to save memory [ ] D) It turns the image into a video

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 2: CREATING & EDITING

D2.2

Unit 4 • Spreadsheet Modeling, Formulas & Functions



Domain 2: Dynamic formula modeling (=SUM, =AVERAGE), absolute cell references, and grid formatting.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Spreadsheets Explained: A spreadsheet (such as **Microsoft Excel** or **Google Sheets**) is a software grid made of vertical **columns** (labelled with letters A, B, C...) and horizontal **rows** (labelled with numbers 1, 2, 3...). Each box is called a **cell**. A cell is identified by its **cell reference** (its coordinates), such as `B4` (Column B, Row 4).

Formulas vs Functions:
• **Formulas:** Calculations you create yourself. Every formula MUST begin with an equals sign (=). Use arithmetic symbols: + (add), - (subtract), * (multiply), and / (divide). *Example:* `=B2*C2` multiplies the quantity in cell B2 by the unit price in cell C2.
• **Functions:** Built-in mathematical shortcuts that perform calculations on a whole group (range) of cells:
  • `=SUM(D2:D20)` → Adds together all numbers in the range D2 to D20.
  • `=AVERAGE(D2:D20)` → Calculates the mean (average) value.
  • `=MIN(D2:D20)` → Finds the lowest value in the range.
  • `=MAX(D2:D20)` → Finds the highest value in the range.
  • `=COUNT(D2:D20)` → Counts how many cells contain numbers.
  • `=IF(C2<10, "Reorder", "OK")` → Checks a condition: if stock in C2 is less than 10, it writes 'Reorder', otherwise 'OK'.

Relative vs Absolute Referencing:
• **Relative Reference (e.g. B2):** When you drag the formula down to the next row, it automatically changes to `B3`, `B4`, etc. This is perfect for row-by-row totals.
• **Absolute Reference (e.g. B1):** The dollar signs lock the cell coordinate in place. When you drag the formula down, it ALWAYS refers back to cell `B1`. *Example:* Storing a 20% VAT rate or £0.45 mileage rate in cell `B1` and locking it as `$B$1` so every calculation uses that exact rate.

Formatting Cells: Always format numbers using the toolbar (e.g. click **Currency (£)** to show two decimal places). *Warning:* Never manually type a pound sign '£' into a calculation cell, or the spreadsheet will treat it as text and produce an error (like `#VALUE!`)!

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Spreadsheet Modeling, Formulas & Functions** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • SPREADSHEET MODELING, FORMULAS & FUNCTIONS

D2.2

Unit 4 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Enter clear, bold column headings in Row 1: Item, Quantity, Unit Cost (£), Total (£).
Step 2:	In cell D2, type the formula `=B2*C2` to calculate the first row's total.
Step 3:	Hover over the bottom-right corner of cell D2 until a small black cross (the Autofill handle) appears, then drag down.
Step 4:	Below your data, calculate totals and averages using `=SUM()` and `=AVERAGE()`.
Step 5:	Highlight money figures and click the Currency (£) button on the ribbon so values show as £0.00.
Step 6:	Highlight your items and totals, then click `Insert → Chart` to create a clear Bar or Column chart.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Typing raw numbers into calculations (like '=B2*14.50') instead of referencing cells. If the price changes later, a cell reference updates automatically, but a hardcoded number stays wrong!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D2.2

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 4 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 4

Scenario: You are managing an office stationery budget spreadsheet with 12 item lines. You have quantities in column B, unit prices in column C, and a 20% VAT tax rate stored in cell H1. Write the exact formula for row 2 to calculate the line subtotal, the formula to calculate VAT referencing cell H1, the function to calculate the grand total across all items, and describe how to format the numbers as pounds and pence.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D2.2

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 4 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Typing raw numbers into calculations (like '=B2*14.50') instead of referencing cells. If the price changes later, a cell reference updates automatically, but a hardcoded number stays wrong!
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 4 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Every spreadsheet formula and function must begin with which character?
[ ] A) + [ ] B) = [ ] C) @ [ ] D) #

2. Which function calculates the mean of values in cells C2 to C15?
[ ] A) =MEAN(C2:C15) [ ] B) =AVERAGE(C2:C15) [ ] C) =AVG(C2-C15) [ ] D) =TOTAL(C2:C15)

3. What do the dollar signs do in the cell reference B1?
[ ] A) They convert the cell to US Dollars [ ] B) They lock the cell coordinate as an absolute reference so it does not change when dragged [ ] C) They multiply the cell by 100 [ ] D) They hide the cell from view

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 2: CREATING & EDITING

D2.3

Unit 5 • Presentation Design, Multimedia & Visual Slides



Domain 2: High-contrast slide layouts, visual hierarchy, embedded multimedia, and accessibility.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Presentation Software: Applications like **Microsoft PowerPoint** and **Google Slides** are used to present information, training courses, and project reviews to an audience. Good slides support what you say; they should never replace you by displaying walls of text.

The 6×6 Rule for Clean Slides: The most common mistake in presentations is putting too many words on a single slide. *The Guideline:* Aim for a maximum of **6 bullet points per slide**, with roughly **6 words per bullet point**.
Why this matters: If a slide is packed with text, your audience will spend their time reading the screen instead of listening to what you are explaining.

Visual Hierarchy & Accessibility:
• **Font Size:** Slide titles should be 32pt to 40pt bold; bullet text should be 20pt to 24pt so people at the back of the room can read comfortably.
• **High Contrast:** Always use dark text on a clean, light background (such as navy or black text on white or warm cream). Avoid yellow text on white or dark text on dark backgrounds.
• **Colour Accessibility:** Never use colour alone to indicate meaning (for example, combine green/red colors with clear text words like 'Passed' or 'Action Needed').
• **Subtitles & Captions:** When playing video clips in a presentation, always turn on closed captions (subtitles) so attendees with hearing difficulties can follow along.

Transitions & Speaker Notes: Keep slide transitions simple and subtle (such as a smooth 'Fade'). Avoid spinning text or loud sound effects, which look amateurish. Use the **Speaker Notes** box below each slide to write your personal reminders—in **Presenter View**, only you can see your notes on your laptop, while the audience sees only the clean slides on the projector.

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Presentation Design, Multimedia & Visual Slides** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D2.3

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • PRESENTATION DESIGN, MULTIMEDIA & VISUAL SLIDES

Unit 5 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Select an accessible, clean slide theme with consistent fonts and high-contrast colours.
Step 2:	Create a Title Slide with the presentation title, your name, and the date.
Step 3:	Structure content slides so each slide covers only one main concept, following the 6x6 bullet rule.
Step 4:	Add high-resolution, relevant photos or charts, and add descriptive Alt-Text to each image.
Step 5:	Apply a subtle 'Fade' transition across all slides for smooth presentation flow.
Step 6:	Practise your talk using Presenter View so you can refer to your speaker notes without looking at the screen.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Filling slides with long paragraphs of tiny text and distracting animations. Slides should be clean, visual summaries with large readable text!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D2.3

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 5 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 5

Scenario: You are designing a 4-slide presentation to train new staff members on office recycling and waste reduction. Outline the title of each slide, draft the 4 bullet points for Slide 2 following the 6x6 rule, and explain two design choices you made to ensure your slides are accessible to people with visual impairments.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D2.3

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 5 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Filling slides with long paragraphs of tiny text and distracting animations. Slides should be clean, visual summaries with large readable text!
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 5 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. What does the '6x6 rule' recommend for presentation slides?
[ ] A) 6 slides presented in 6 minutes [ ] B) Maximum 6 bullet points per slide, with about 6 words per bullet point [ ] C) 6 pictures on every slide [ ] D) 6 different font colours per slide

2. Why should you avoid using yellow text on a white slide background?
[ ] A) Yellow ink is more expensive [ ] B) It has low contrast and is very difficult for the audience to read [ ] C) PowerPoint does not allow yellow text [ ] D) It deletes the text when saved

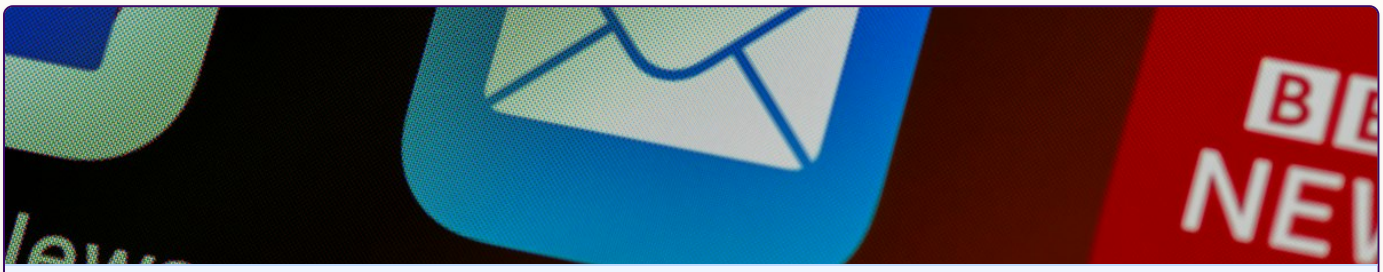
3. What is the benefit of using 'Presenter View' during a live presentation?
[ ] A) It plays background music [ ] B) It lets you see your speaker notes and upcoming slides on your screen while the audience sees only the slide [ ] C) It turns off the projector [ ] D) It automatically answers audience questions

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 3: COMMUNICATING

D3.1

Unit 6 • Professional Email Etiquette, CC/BCC & Data Privacy



Domain 3: Professional subject lines, secure attachments, and data privacy protocols (CC vs BCC).

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Workplace Email Protocols: Email is the primary written communication tool in employment. Unlike a quick text or messaging app, a workplace email is a permanent, formal record that can be used as evidence in business disputes. Always maintain a polite, respectful tone, use proper spelling and grammar, and avoid slang or emojis.

Understanding Address Fields (To, CC, and BCC):
• **To:** The main person (or people) who the email is addressed to, and who is expected to reply or take action.
• **CC (Carbon Copy):** People who need to see the message for information, but who do not need to reply. *Example:* Sending a completed report to a client and putting your manager in CC so they know it was delivered.
• **BCC (Blind Carbon Copy):** Sends a copy of the email while **completely hiding** the recipient's email address from everyone else on the list.
Crucial Data Protection Rule (UK GDPR): Whenever you email a group of customers, clients, students, or patients, you **must put their addresses in BCC**. If you put them in 'To' or 'CC', everyone can see each other's private email addresses. Exposing customer contact details without consent is a serious legal data breach that can result in heavy fines!

Email Structure & Netiquette:
• **Subject Line:** Always write a clear, helpful subject line that summarizes the topic (e.g. `Urgent: Staff Meeting Rescheduled to Thursday 14:00` instead of just `Meeting` or leaving it empty).
• **Salutation & Sign-off:** Open with a polite greeting (`Dear Mr Davis,` or `Good morning Sarah,`) and close with a professional sign-off (`Kind regards,` followed by your name and job title).
• **No ALL CAPS:** Never write emails in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS—in digital communication, this is seen as shouting and is considered aggressive.
• **Attachments:** Keep file attachments under 10 MB so they do not bounce back or fill up the recipient's mailbox. For larger files, send a secure cloud sharing link instead.

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Professional Email Etiquette, CC/BCC & Data Privacy** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D3.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • PROFESSIONAL EMAIL ETIQUETTE, CC/BCC & DATA PRIVACY

Unit 6 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Write a clear, descriptive subject line that includes the project name or action required.
Step 2:	Choose the correct address field: action owners in 'To', observers in 'CC', and group mailing lists in 'BCC'.
Step 3:	Write a polite greeting and structure your message into short paragraphs with bullet points for actions.
Step 4:	Attach any needed documents, ensuring file names are professional (e.g. `Invoice_1042.pdf`, not `scan1.pdf`).
Step 5:	Proofread your email carefully for spelling, tone, and correct recipient addresses before clicking 'Send'.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Clicking 'Reply All' when only the original sender needs your answer! 'Reply All' clutters everyone's inbox and can accidentally leak private comments to the entire organisation.

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D3.1

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 6 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 6

Scenario: You work as an administrative officer at an adult education college. You need to email 35 prospective students to confirm their course start dates and enclose a PDF campus map. Draft the email including a suitable subject line and greeting, explain why placing all 35 email addresses in 'To' or 'CC' violates UK GDPR data protection rules, and specify which field must be used instead.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D3.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 6 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Clicking 'Reply All' when only the original sender needs your answer! 'Reply All' clutters everyone's inbox and can accidentally leak private comments to the entire organisation.
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 6 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which email field should you use when emailing 50 customers to ensure they cannot see each other's email addresses?
[ ] A) To [ ] B) CC [ ] C) BCC (Blind Carbon Copy) [ ] D) Subject

2. Why is typing an email in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS considered bad netiquette?
[ ] A) It uses more computer memory [ ] B) It is interpreted as shouting and feels rude or aggressive [ ] C) Capital letters cannot be sent over Wi-Fi [ ] D) It triggers anti-virus alerts

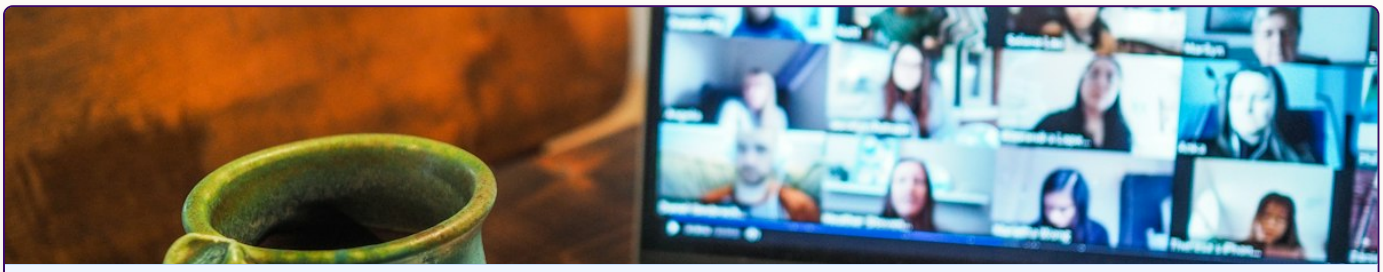
3. What makes an effective email subject line?
[ ] A) Leaving it completely blank [ ] B) Writing just the word 'Hey' [ ] C) A concise, descriptive summary of the message topic and any deadline [ ] D) Typing your whole message into the subject line

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 3: COMMUNICATING

D3.2

Unit 7 • Video Conferencing, Screen Sharing & Online Collaboration



Domain 3: Video meeting etiquette, screen sharing, active muting, and digital team collaboration.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Video Conferencing Tools: Applications like **Microsoft Teams**, **Zoom**, and **Google Meet** allow people to talk, see each other, and collaborate on work from different locations over the internet. They are now an everyday part of modern employment, training courses, and healthcare consultations.

Audio & Video Etiquette (Netiquette):
• **Mute When Not Speaking:** Always keep your microphone muted unless you are actively speaking. This stops distracting background noises (such as keyboard typing, coughing, phone rings, traffic, or family members) from disturbing the meeting.
• **Camera & Background Privacy:** When turning on your webcam, ensure you are in a quiet, well-lit room. Use the **Background Blur** feature or select a neutral virtual background to keep your personal home living space private.
• **Raise Hand:** Use the digital 'Raise Hand' button to let the host know you have a question or contribution without interrupting whoever is speaking.

Screen Sharing Safely: Screen sharing allows other attendees to see your computer screen (for example, to show a presentation or spreadsheet).
The Golden Privacy Rule: Always choose to **Share a Specific Window** (such as sharing only your PowerPoint application) rather than **Share Entire Screen (Desktop)**. If you share your entire desktop, everyone on the call will see private email notifications, open bank accounts, or confidential customer files that pop up on your monitor!

Cloud Collaboration & Co-Authoring: In platforms like Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace, multiple colleagues can open and edit the same document at the exact same time. Each person appears with a different coloured cursor so you can see what they are typing in real time without overwriting each other's work.

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Video Conferencing, Screen Sharing & Online Collaboration** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D3.2

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • VIDEO CONFERENCING, SCREEN SHARING & ONLINE COLLABORATION

Unit 7 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Join the meeting 2 to 3 minutes early to test your audio (microphone and speakers/headset) and webcam.
Step 2:	Turn on Background Blur to ensure your personal home surroundings remain private.
Step 3:	Mute your microphone immediately upon entering the call.
Step 4:	When sharing work, select only the specific application window you need to show, never your whole desktop.
Step 5:	Use the in-meeting chat box to share links or type comments without interrupting the speaker.
Step 6:	Click the red 'Leave' or 'End Meeting' button firmly when finished to ensure your camera and microphone disconnect.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Sharing your entire desktop screen during a video call. If personal emails or sensitive customer records are visible, this is a serious data protection breach! Always share only the specific application window.

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D3.2

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 7 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 7

Scenario: You are participating in a weekly team review meeting with 10 colleagues on Microsoft Teams. You have been asked to present a 5-minute update on your department's monthly targets. Outline 3 technical checks you should perform before joining, explain why sharing a single window is safer than sharing your entire desktop screen, and describe two meeting etiquette rules you should follow while others are speaking.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

D3.2

Unit 7 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Sharing your entire desktop screen during a video call. If personal emails or sensitive customer records are visible, this is a serious data protection breach! Always share only the specific application window.
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 7 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Why should you mute your microphone during a video call when you are not speaking?
[ ] A) To save internet bandwidth [ ] B) To prevent background noise from distracting the speaker and other participants [ ] C) To stop your screen from turning off [ ] D) Because microphones only work for 5 minutes

2. When presenting work on a video call, why is sharing a single window safer than sharing your entire screen?
[ ] A) It uses less computer battery [ ] B) It stops attendees from seeing private notifications, personal emails, or confidential data on your desktop [ ] C) Single windows load faster on phones [ ] D) It turns off attendee webcams

3. What feature in video conferencing apps protects your home privacy when your camera is turned on?
[ ] A) Screen Magnifier [ ] B) Background Blur or Virtual Background [ ] C) Autofill [ ] D) High Contrast Mode

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 4: TRANSACTING

D4.1

Unit 8 • E-Commerce Navigation, Secure Payments & Online Shopping



Domain 4: E-commerce verification, SSL encryption certificates, and fraud prevention.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

What is E-Commerce? E-commerce (electronic commerce) means buying, selling, or paying for goods and services over the internet. Examples include buying equipment from an online store, booking train tickets, ordering food deliveries, or paying an invoice online.

Checking for a Secure Connection (HTTPS & The SSL Padlock): Before you enter any personal details, passwords, or bank card numbers on a shopping website, always look at the browser address bar:
• **HTTPS:** The website address must begin with `https://` (the **S** stands for **Secure**).
• **The Padlock Icon:** A locked padlock symbol should appear next to the web address.
What this means: The connection is protected by **SSL/TLS encryption**. This scrambles all data sent between your computer and the store's server so hackers cannot intercept your card numbers or passwords.
Crucial Warning: The padlock proves your connection is encrypted, but it does NOT guarantee the company is honest! Criminals can set up fake websites with padlocks. Always verify the company's real reputation, reviews, and address before purchasing.

Secure Payment Gateways & 3D Secure:
• **Protected Payment Services:** Using services like **PayPal**, **Apple Pay**, or **Google Pay** is safer than typing raw credit card numbers on every website, because they never reveal your card numbers to the seller.
• **Strong Customer Authentication (3D Secure):** When you buy something online, your bank will often ask you to approve the purchase by entering a one-time code sent to your phone or confirming it in your banking app. This stops criminals from using your card if it is stolen.
• **Order Verification:** Always review your digital shopping basket before paying (checking quantities, postage fees, and VAT). Save the confirmation page and download the PDF receipt with the order reference number in case you need a refund.

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **E-Commerce Navigation, Secure Payments & Online Shopping** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D4.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • E-COMMERCE NAVIGATION, SECURE PAYMENTS & ONLINE SHOPPING

Unit 8 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Check the browser address bar for `https://` and the locked padlock symbol before entering personal data.
Step 2:	Verify the seller's legitimacy: look for a genuine UK physical address, contact telephone number, and clear returns policy.
Step 3:	Review your shopping basket carefully to verify quantities, delivery charges, and total costs before clicking checkout.
Step 4:	Pay using a protected payment method (such as PayPal, Apple Pay, Google Pay, or a credit card with fraud protection).
Step 5:	Complete the two-step bank security check (3D Secure) on your phone when prompted.
Step 6:	Save or print the order confirmation screen and download the PDF invoice for your records.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Assuming that a website is 100% genuine just because it has a padlock icon. A padlock only proves the connection is encrypted—you must still check the domain name and customer reviews to avoid fake shopping websites!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D4.1

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 8 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 8

Scenario: Your office manager asks you to purchase £280 of computer accessories from a new online supplier that your company has never used before. Describe 4 safety and security checks you must carry out before entering company payment details, explain what the 'https://' and padlock symbol mean, and explain why saving the order confirmation receipt is essential.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D4.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 8 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Assuming that a website is 100% genuine just because it has a padlock icon. A padlock only proves the connection is encrypted—you must still check the domain name and customer reviews to avoid fake shopping websites!
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 8 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. What does the 's' stand for in 'https://' at the start of a website address?
[ ] A) Standard [ ] B) Secure (data is encrypted between your browser and the website) [ ] C) System [ ] D) Software

2. What is the primary function of Strong Customer Authentication (3D Secure) during online checkout?
[ ] A) It gives you a discount on postage [ ] B) It asks you to verify the transaction via your banking app or an SMS code to prevent fraud [ ] C) It cancels your order automatically [ ] D) It turns off your credit card

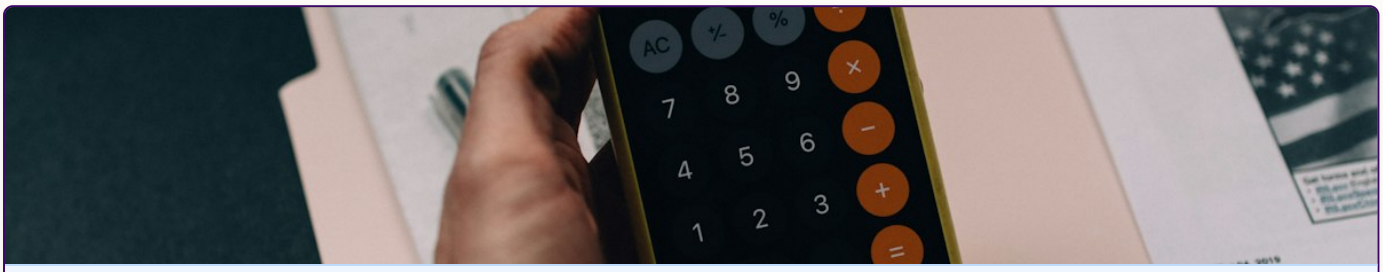
3. Why is using a protected service like PayPal or Apple Pay safer than typing your card number on an unfamiliar website?
[ ] A) It makes delivery twice as fast [ ] B) It does not share your actual bank card details directly with the seller [ ] C) It deletes your bank account [ ] D) It allows you to buy items without paying

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 4: TRANSACTING

D4.2

Unit 9 • Digital Public Services & Official Online Accounts



Domain 4: Navigating government portals (GOV.UK), digital identification, and online service forms.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Accessing Public Services Online: In the UK, public and government services are designed to be accessed online to make services faster and reduce paperwork. Examples include **GOV.UK** (for renewing a passport, applying for Universal Credit, taxing a vehicle, or checking your state pension), the **NHS App** (for ordering repeat prescriptions, booking appointments, and viewing medical records), and local **Council websites** (for paying Council Tax and parking permits).

Spotting Official Websites vs Copycat Scams:
• **Official UK Government websites strictly end in `.gov.uk`.**
• **Official NHS websites strictly end in `.nhs.uk`.**
Watch out for copycat websites: If you search Google for services like 'renew driving licence' or 'apply for a UK passport', the top sponsored results are often private commercial companies. These websites look very official, but they charge you £30 to £80 in extra 'administration fees' just to forward your form to the government! *Golden Rule:* Always check that the web address ends in `.gov.uk` where government services are free or charged only at the legal statutory fee.

Completing Online Forms & Uploading Documents:
• **Mandatory Fields (marked with a red asterisk *):** These boxes MUST be filled in before you can submit the form.
• **Data Validation:** Online forms check that your entries match expected rules. For example, if you enter an invalid postcode or leave out digits from your telephone number, the box will highlight in red with an error message explaining what to correct.
• **Document Uploads:** You will often need to upload proof of identity (like a photo of your passport, driving licence, or utility bill). Make sure files are clear, saved in a standard format (`.pdf` or `.jpg`), and within the maximum file size limit (usually under 5 MB).

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Digital Public Services & Official Online Accounts** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D4.2

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • DIGITAL PUBLIC SERVICES & OFFICIAL ONLINE ACCOUNTS

Unit 9 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Verify the website address ends in `.gov.uk` or `.nhs.uk` before beginning any application.
Step 2:	Log in using your verified government gateway credentials or register a secure account with a strong passphrase.
Step 3:	Fill in each section of the form methodically, reading all guidance notes carefully.
Step 4:	If an error message appears in red, read the feedback and correct the formatting (e.g. check postcode spacing).
Step 5:	Upload clear, legible photos or PDF scans of required proof-of-identity documents.
Step 6:	Review your summary answers, submit the form, and write down your unique application tracking reference code.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Using commercial copycat websites that charge unnecessary fees for free public services. Genuine UK government services are always hosted strictly on domains ending in .gov.uk!

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D4.2

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 9 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 9

Scenario: A 55-year-old family member needs to renew their UK driving licence online and order a repeat prescription from their GP. Explain how they can be certain they are using genuine official websites rather than paid copycat services, describe the steps to complete the form and upload a photograph, and explain how Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) protects their government account.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

D4.2

Unit 9 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

★ Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Using commercial copycat websites that charge unnecessary fees for free public services. Genuine UK government services are always hosted strictly on domains ending in .gov.uk!
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

▶ Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 9 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which domain ending guarantees that a web service is an official UK government portal?
[ ] A) .gov.uk [ ] B) .government.com [ ] C) .uk-services.org [ ] D) .gov.co.uk

2. What does a red asterisk (*) next to a box on an online form mean?
[ ] A) The box is optional [ ] B) The box is mandatory and must be filled in before submitting [ ] C) The box contains an error [ ] D) The box will be deleted

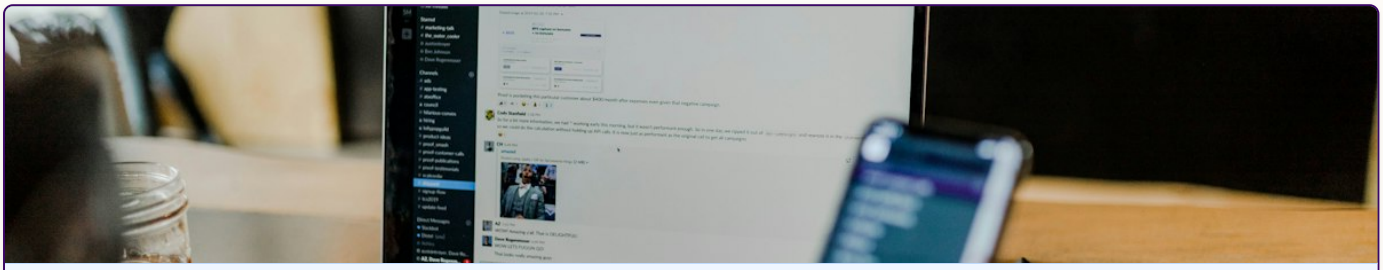
3. Why should you avoid using third-party intermediary websites when renewing a UK passport or driving licence?
[ ] A) They only accept cash [ ] B) They charge unnecessary extra fees for services that are cheaper or free on GOV.UK [ ] C) They do not work on computers [ ] D) They make your passport expire early

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

EDSQ DOMAIN: DOMAIN 5: BEING SAFE & RESPONSIBLE ONLINE

D5.1

Unit 10 • Cybersecurity, Passwords, MFA & UK GDPR Compliance



Domain 5: Multi-factor authentication (MFA), phishing red flags, and UK GDPR data compliance.

Core Knowledge & Specialist Terms Explained

Staying Safe Online: Most cybercrime succeeds by tricking people into making mistakes rather than hacking code. Staying safe requires vigilant personal habits and knowing key security rules.

Phishing (Spotting Fraudulent Messages):
Definition: **Phishing** is when criminals send fake emails or texts (smishing) impersonating trusted organisations (banks, Royal Mail, Netflix, HMRC) to steal passwords, card details, or download malware.
Warning Signs:
1. **Artificial Urgency:** Demanding immediate action under threat of account suspension or fines.
2. **Suspicious Sender:** Display name looks real, but actual email address is unfamiliar.
3. **Generic Greetings:** 'Dear Customer' instead of your name.
4. **Requests for PINs:** Banks and HMRC never ask for passwords or PINs by email or text.
5. **Suspicious Links:** Always hover over links to check the real URL before clicking.

Strong Passwords & Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):
• **Three Random Words:** The NCSC recommends passphrases of **three random, memorable words** with numbers/symbols (e.g. `Purple$Pebble72Blanket!`)—virtually impossible to crack, yet easy to remember.
• **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** Requires your password plus a temporary code sent to your phone or app. Criminals cannot log in without your physical device.

UK GDPR & Personal Data Rights:
Definition: The **UK GDPR** protects living individuals' **personal data** (names, addresses, health notes, financial records).
Workplace Rules: Keep personal data confidential, store files on encrypted drives, never share passwords, lock your screen (`Win + L`) when stepping away, and report serious data breaches to the **ICO (Information Commissioner's Office)** within **72 hours**.

Everyday Workplace Context

In modern jobs and community life, mastering **Cybersecurity, Passwords, MFA & UK GDPR Compliance** helps you work faster, keep data secure, and avoid costly mistakes.

D5.1

PROCEDURAL MASTERY • CYBERSECURITY, PASSWORDS, MFA & UK GDPR COMPLIANCE

Unit 10 • Step-by-Step Workflow

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) • How to Do It Step-by-Step

Step 1:	Create strong, unique passphrases for each important account using the three random words method.
Step 2:	Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on your email, banking, and workplace logins.
Step 3:	Hover your mouse over links in emails to inspect the real URL before clicking anything.
Step 4:	Lock your computer workstation (`Win + L`) every single time you step away from your desk.
Step 5:	Never store passwords on sticky notes attached to your monitor or in unencrypted text files.
Step 6:	Immediately report any suspicious email or accidental data loss to your IT support team or manager.

Productivity Tip

Create desktop shortcuts for folders you open every day to save navigation time.

Examiner Pitfall!

Examiner Trap: Believing that anti-virus software protects you against all cyber threats. Anti-virus blocks computer viruses, but it cannot stop you from being tricked into typing your password into a fake phishing website! Your own careful checking is your best defence.

✎ Candidate Command Triggers & Shortcut Reminders

D5.1

REAL-WORLD WORKPLACE SCENARIO TASK

Unit 10 • Applied Workplace Drill

Workplace Simulation Task • Unit 10

Scenario: You receive an email appearing to come from your company IT Helpdesk saying: 'URGENT: Your work email account will be deactivated tonight due to a storage error. Click here immediately to confirm your password and prevent account deletion.' Identify 3 clear warning signs that indicate this email is a phishing attack, state what you must do, and explain how Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) protects your account.

✎ Candidate Action Log & Step-by-Step Solution Working Grid

Practical Drill Sign-Off

Drill Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

D5.1

ERROR REMEDIATION & MULTIPLE-CHOICE CHECK

Unit 10 • Pitfall Audit & Knowledge Check

Critical Traps to Avoid & How to Prevent Them

Trap: Examiner Trap: Believing that anti-virus software protects you against all cyber threats. Anti-virus blocks computer viruses, but it cannot stop you from being tricked into typing your password into a fake phishing website! Your own careful checking is your best defence.
Prevention: Double-check inputs, lock passwords with two-factor authentication, and verify recipient email addresses before sending.

Statutory Knowledge Verification

Unit 10 Knowledge Check Questions:

1. Which of the following is recommended by the UK National Cyber Security Centre for creating strong passwords?
[ ] A) Using your pet's name followed by '123' [ ] B) Combining three random, memorable words with numbers and symbols (e.g. Purple$Pebble72Blanket!) [ ] C) Using the word 'Password2026' [ ] D) Using your date of birth

2. What is Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA / 2FA)?
[ ] A) Changing your password every 10 minutes [ ] B) A security system requiring two verification steps to log in (e.g. password + code sent to your phone) [ ] C) Having two different computer screens [ ] D) Using two different keyboards

3. Under UK GDPR, within how many hours must an organisation report a serious personal data breach to the ICO?
[ ] A) 12 hours [ ] B) 72 hours [ ] C) 14 days [ ] D) 30 days

✎ Candidate Working Notes & Unit Summary Reflection

ME1.1

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: MEDICAL PRACTICE PORTAL & PATIENT RECORDS ADMINISTRATION

Mock Exam 1 • Scenario Overview



Scenario 1: Healthcare digital administration, confidential patient data management, and booking portals.

Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are working as an Administrative Assistant at St Jude Medical Practice. The Practice Manager has asked you to organise patient records, prepare a patient communications document, research official health guidelines, and handle confidential digital messages while strictly following UK GDPR data protection rules.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Create a logical 3-tier folder structure for clinic documents across 3 medical departments (General Practice, Phlebotomy, Physiotherapy). Write standard file names using dates and version numbers, and explain why patient files must be stored on secure cloud drives rather than on the local Desktop. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: MEDICAL PRACTICE PORTAL & PATIENT RECORDS ADMINISTRATION

ME1.2

Mock Exam 1 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2 (Word Processing & Document Layout): Format a 2-page Patient Services Welcome Guide in Microsoft Word. Apply Heading 1 and Heading 2 styles, insert an automatic Table of Contents, format an accessible appointment clinic schedule table with a bold header row, and add descriptive Alt-Text to the practice logo. **[15 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)

★ Formula Verification Checklist

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

ME1.3

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: MEDICAL PRACTICE PORTAL & PATIENT RECORDS ADMINISTRATION

Mock Exam 1 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3 (Information Verification & Research): Research official NHS guidance on adult seasonal flu vaccination eligibility. Formulate two search queries using operators (including site:.nhs.uk), identify two trusted health domains, and apply the CRAAP test to evaluate source reliability. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 1: PRACTICAL MOCK 1: MEDICAL PRACTICE PORTAL & PATIENT RECORDS ADMINISTRATION

ME1.4

Mock Exam 1 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4 (Professional Email & Data Privacy): Draft a formal email to 40 eligible patients inviting them to book a vaccination appointment. Correctly allocate addresses across To, CC, and BCC fields to prevent unlawful data disclosure under UK GDPR, and attach an encrypted PDF clinic map. **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

▶ Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 1 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: Abdul • _____**

ME2.1

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: COMMUNITY FOOD BANK LOGISTICS & STOCK TRACKING

Mock Exam 2 • Scenario Overview



Scenario 2: Food bank logistics tracking, stock distribution formulas, and volunteer communication.

Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are the Operations Assistant for a regional community food bank charity. The operations manager needs an automated inventory spreadsheet to track food donations, monitor stock reorder thresholds, analyse donation data with a chart, and send updates to volunteers.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1 (Spreadsheet Modeling & Calculations): Construct an inventory tracking spreadsheet for 15 essential food categories. Create formulas for Line Total (=Unit Weight * Quantity in Stock), Total Weight using =SUM(), and Average Items per Category using =AVERAGE(). **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: COMMUNITY FOOD BANK LOGISTICS & STOCK TRACKING

ME2.2

Mock Exam 2 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2 (Conditional Formulas & Threshold Alerts): Apply an automated =IF() function in Column G to display 'RESTOCK URGENT' if an item has fewer than 20 units remaining, or 'ADEQUATE' if stock is 20 or more. Format numbers with clear decimal places and apply Currency formatting where appropriate. **[15 Marks]**

✎ **Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)**

★ **Formula Verification Checklist**

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

ME2.3

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: COMMUNITY FOOD BANK LOGISTICS & STOCK TRACKING

Mock Exam 2 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3 (Data Visualisation & Charting): Generate a high-contrast Clustered Column Chart comparing stock quantities across food categories. Add a descriptive chart title, clearly label both the X-axis and Y-axis, and display data values above each bar. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 2: PRACTICAL MOCK 2: COMMUNITY FOOD BANK LOGISTICS & STOCK TRACKING

ME2.4

Mock Exam 2 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4 (Volunteer Communication & Privacy): Compose a professional email update to the charity's 25 weekend volunteers. Explain why volunteer email addresses must be placed in BCC rather than CC, attach the weekly distribution schedule, and explain how to recover a previous version of the spreadsheet if data is accidentally deleted. **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

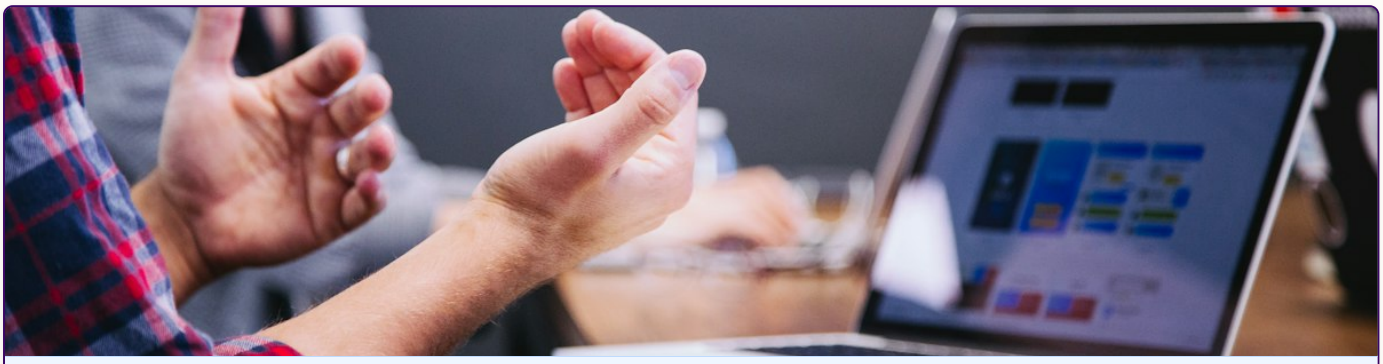
▶ Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 2 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: Abdul • _____**

ME3.1

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: APPRENTICE TRAINING HUB & E-LEARNING ADMINISTRATION

Mock Exam 3 • Scenario Overview



Scenario 3: E-learning platform management, apprentice progress spreadsheets, and qualification records.

▶ Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are an Apprentice Support Coordinator for a vocational skills academy. You must organise digital learning resources for 30 new apprentices, manage virtual induction sessions, and review cybersecurity incident reports.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1 (Virtual Meeting Setup & Etiquette): Schedule a virtual induction session on Microsoft Teams for 30 apprentices. Configure meeting options (Presenter vs Attendee roles, lobby bypass), compose the meeting invitation with a clear agenda, and write 3 video call etiquette rules for attendees. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: APPRENTICE TRAINING HUB & E-LEARNING ADMINISTRATION

ME3.2

Mock Exam 3 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2 (Digital Presentation Design): Design a 4-slide Apprentice Digital Safety presentation following the 6x6 rule. Outline slide titles, bullet points for Slide 2 (Password Security & 2FA), and explain two design choices made to ensure visual accessibility. **[15 Marks]**

✎ **Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)**

★ **Formula Verification Checklist**

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: APPRENTICE TRAINING HUB & E-LEARNING ADMINISTRATION

ME3.3

Mock Exam 3 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage): Review an incident where an apprentice clicked a suspicious link in an email claiming to offer an 'Apprentice Travel Grant'. Identify 4 red flags of phishing, outline the immediate steps to isolate the computer, and complete an incident triage log. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 3: PRACTICAL MOCK 3: APPRENTICE TRAINING HUB & E-LEARNING ADMINISTRATION

ME3.4

Mock Exam 3 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4 (Data Protection & Subject Access): Outline the procedure for handling a Subject Access Request (SAR) under UK GDPR from an apprentice requesting their training records, specifying the statutory response deadline (1 calendar month) and verification steps. **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 3 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: Abdul • _____**

ME4.1

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: DIGITAL LIBRARY ARCHIVE & ASSET LOAN MANAGEMENT

Mock Exam 4 • Scenario Overview



Scenario 4: Digital asset cataloging, lending audit calculations, and equipment loan tracking.

▶ Candidate Briefing • 50 Marks • 1 hr 45 mins

Scenario Context: You are supporting the Digital Systems Officer at a municipal library and digital media archive. You need to audit hardware loan equipment, evaluate secure online payment options for library fines, and verify digital copyright compliance for archived materials.

Task 1 (File Hierarchy & Storage Architecture): Task 1 (Equipment Loan Spreadsheet & Validation): Build a spreadsheet tracking 20 loaned laptops and Wi-Fi dongles. Use cell locking ($) to calculate daily late penalty charges, format cells as Currency (£), and configure Data Validation to restrict loan status entries to an approved dropdown list (Available, On Loan, Under Repair). **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Folder Architecture & File Paths

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: DIGITAL LIBRARY ARCHIVE & ASSET LOAN MANAGEMENT

ME4.2

Mock Exam 4 • Task 2 (Spreadsheet Modeling)

Task 2 (Spreadsheet Calculations & Formatting): Task 2 (E-Commerce & Online Payments Audit): Evaluate 3 digital payment solutions for accepting online library fine payments. Identify the required security standards, including SSL/TLS padlock encryption, 3D Secure customer verification, and compliance with data security standards. **[15 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Working Grid • Formula Syntax (=SUM, =AVERAGE, =IF)

★ Formula Verification Checklist

Verify: (1) Absolute cell references (B1) are locked where appropriate. (2) Currency formatting applied (£0.00). (3) Gridlines visible for printing.

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: DIGITAL LIBRARY ARCHIVE & ASSET LOAN MANAGEMENT

ME4.3

Mock Exam 4 • Task 3 (Email & Communication)

Task 3 (Professional Workplace Correspondence): Task 3 (Copyright & Creative Commons Licensing): Explain the legal rules under the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 for publishing historic library photographs on the public website, distinguishing between copyright-protected material, Public Domain, and Creative Commons (CC-BY) licenses. **[12 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Email Drafting Area (Subject, Salutation, Body, Sign-Off)

PRACTICAL EXAM 4: PRACTICAL MOCK 4: DIGITAL LIBRARY ARCHIVE & ASSET LOAN MANAGEMENT

ME4.4

Mock Exam 4 • Task 4 (Security Incident)

Task 4 (Cybersecurity Incident Triage & Reporting): Task 4 (Workstation Ergonomics & DSE Audit): Complete a Display Screen Equipment (DSE) workstation health audit for library computer terminals, explaining screen height, chair lumbar support, wrist positioning, and the 20-20-20 visual rest rule. **[11 Marks]**

✎ Candidate Incident Triage & Action Report

Practical Exam Summary & Sign-Off

Mock 4 Total Marks: _____ / 50 **Status: [ ] Pass [ ] Refer** **Examiner: Abdul • _____**

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB1

Lab 1: Cloud Storage Architecture & Access Permissions



Software Lab 1: Configuring tiered cloud permissions (View, Comment, Edit) and corporate audit logs.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Cloud Security Framework: In shared cloud drives (such as SharePoint, Google Drive, or Nextcloud), giving everyone 'Edit' access to main folders is dangerous because anyone can accidentally delete important files.

The 3 Standard Permission Tiers:
• **Viewer (Read-Only):** People can view and read files, but cannot make any changes or delete anything. Ideal for company policies and reference guides.
• **Commenter:** People can read the document and leave feedback notes in the margins, but cannot change the text itself.
• **Editor:** Assigned project team members who have permission to write, edit, and update the document.

Version History & Recovery: If someone accidentally deletes text or corrupts a file, click `File → Info → Version History` to view previous saved versions and restore the document in one click.

Standard Operating Checklist: Tiered Permissions

1. Root Folder Setup:	Create a structured project folder with format: `[Dept]_[ProjectName]_[Year]`.
2. Subfolder Partitioning:	Establish segregated subfolders: `01_Reference` (Read-Only), `02_WIP` (Edit for Team), `03_Confidential` (Restricted).
3. Link Security Configuration:	Disable 'Anyone with the link' public sharing. Enforce organizational email domain authentication with 30-day password expiry.

LAB1

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB1 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are deploying a shared cloud workspace for a regional healthcare recruitment drive involving 40 confidential applicant CVs and an open interviewer schedule.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Diagram a 3-tier folder structure ensuring interviewers cannot edit master candidate scorecards.
2. Write the exact permission settings (Read-only, Edit, Restricted) for 3 distinct user groups.
3. Outline the 4-step emergency recovery procedure if an interviewer accidentally deletes the schedule.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

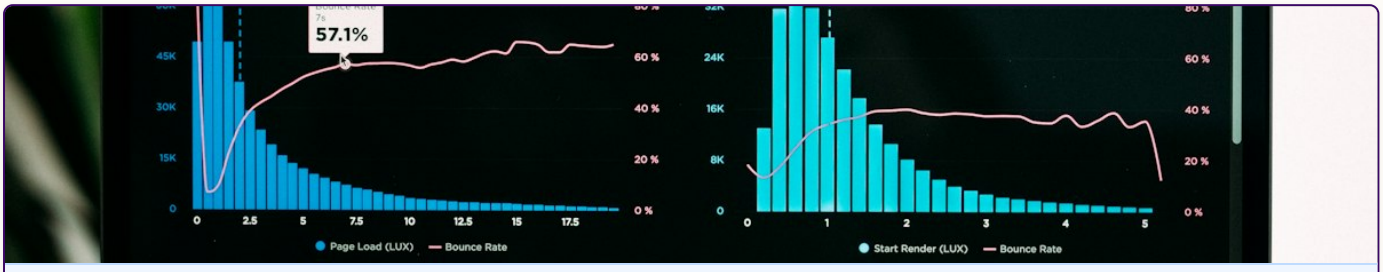
Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB2

Lab 2: Advanced Spreadsheet Modeling & Data Validation



Software Lab 2: Input data validation dropdowns, error handling (=IFERROR), and conditional alerts.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Spreadsheet Accuracy: Workplace spreadsheets handle payroll, stock budgets, and invoices. A single missing dollar sign in an absolute reference (like `B1` instead of `$B$1`) causes calculations to shift and produce massive errors when autofilled down a column.

Data Validation (Dropdown Menus): Restricting user typing to pre-set dropdown lists (e.g. 'Approved Expense Categories') stops people making spelling mistakes that break lookup formulas like `=VLOOKUP()` and `=IF()`.

Handling Common Errors:

- `#DIV/0!`: You are trying to divide by zero or an empty cell.
- `#VALUE!`: A formula is trying to do math on a word or text string (e.g. typing £15 instead of formatting as currency).
- `#REF!`: A cell used in your formula was accidentally deleted.
- `#####`: The column is simply too narrow to display the number—double-click the column boundary line to widen it!

Standard Operating Checklist: Formula Modeling

1. Absolute Cell Locking:	Lock tax rates or exchange rate parameters using $ syntax (e.g. `=A2 * $E$1`) before dragging fill handles.
2. Dynamic Dropdown Lists:	Implement Data Validation → List → specify source range to enforce uniform category naming conventions.
3. Conditional Alerts:	Apply conditional formatting rules to highlight values exceeding budget limits in bold red with light pink shading.

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB2

LAB2 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are designing an automated departmental petty cash and travel reimbursement model for 15 field technicians.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Construct the formula to calculate mileage allowance (£0.45/mile) referencing locked cell `$C$1`.
2. Write the syntax for an `=IF()` statement that flags any expense over £100 as 'REQUIRES SENIOR SIGN-OFF'.
3. Detail how to identify and resolve a `#VALUE!` error caused by text characters in a numerical column.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

LAB3

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

Lab 3: Professional Business Correspondence & Netiquette



Software Lab 3: Formal business dispute resolution, distribution governance, and calendar meeting invites.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Professional Email Architecture: Business email is a permanent legal record. Messages must have a concise, descriptive subject line (e.g. `[URGENT] Q3 Financial Audit Review - Action Required by 17:00`), professional salutation, structured body paragraphs, and a compliant corporate signature banner.

The Confidentiality Imperative (CC vs BCC): The UK Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) penalizes organizations thousands of pounds for exposing customer email addresses by using the CC field instead of BCC during group mailings.

Calendar Meeting Invites: Scheduling meetings via digital calendars (Outlook, Teams, Google Calendar) requires checking availability, setting meeting locations or video links, and providing a clear agenda.

Standard Operating Checklist: Email Governance

1. Subject Line Protocol:	Always include project prefix, topic summary, and response deadline.
2. BCC Privacy Rule:	Any distribution list to external clients or patients MUST utilize BCC to comply with UK Data Protection regulations.
3. Meeting Invitation Workflow:	Include agenda bullet points, video conference URL, and attachments directly within calendar invites.

LAB3

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB3 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: A critical delivery of medical training equipment has been delayed by 72 hours, impacting a scheduled apprentice certification day.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Draft the formal email to the Lead Course Instructor acknowledging the delay and presenting two contingency solutions.
2. Explain why individual student email addresses must be placed in BCC rather than CC.
3. Create a structured calendar meeting invitation with agenda to review contingency options at 08:30 tomorrow.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB4

Lab 4: Cybersecurity Vulnerability Triage & Phishing Defense



Software Lab 4: Analyzing suspicious email headers, domain spoofing triage, and emergency containment.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

How Phishing Works: Cybercriminals rarely hack complicated software; they trick people by pretending to be trusted colleagues, managers, or organisations. They create panic ('Act within 1 hour!') and disguise fake links behind official-looking buttons.

Inspecting Email Headers & Links: Always check the actual email address after the @ symbol (e.g. `@hmrc-tax-refund.co.uk` is fake; real government emails end strictly in `@hmrc.gov.uk`). Hover your mouse over links to see the real destination address.

Emergency Incident Steps: If you click a bad link or enter a password by mistake, immediately disconnect your device from the Wi-Fi or unplug the internet cable. Do NOT turn off the computer (this preserves memory evidence for IT investigators), and report the incident immediately.

Standard Operating Checklist: Threat Triage

1. Header & Domain Inspection:	Verify sender email domain exactly (e.g. `@hmrc-tax-refund.co.uk` vs legitimate `@hmrc.gov.uk`).
2. Link Destination Hover:	Hover without clicking to inspect the true hyperlinked URL in the browser status bar.
3. Incident Escalation:	Disconnect Wi-Fi / ethernet immediately, notify InfoSec officer, and log incident details.

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB4

LAB4 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: An employee in accounts payable receives an urgent email appearing to come from the Managing Director requesting an immediate £8,500 bank transfer to an unknown vendor account.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Identify 4 distinct red flags that indicate this email is a Business Email Compromise (BEC) attack.
2. Complete a statutory 4-point Cybersecurity Incident Triage Log.
3. Outline the verification protocol required before any unusual financial transfer is authorized.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

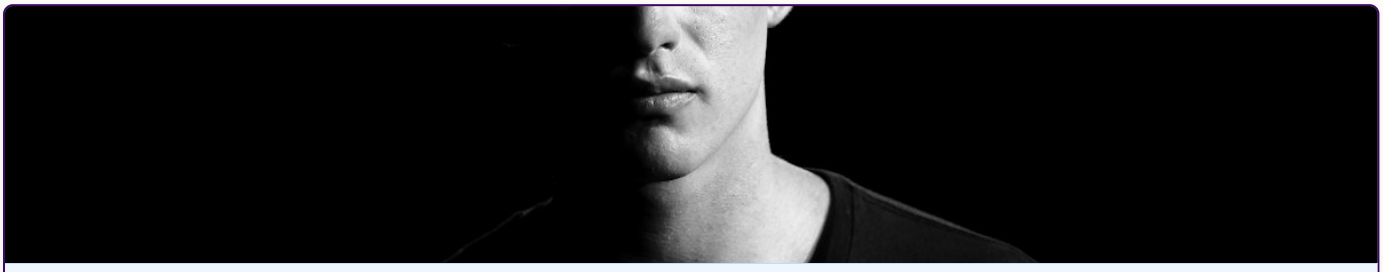
Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB5

Lab 5: Corporate Document Processing & Accessibility



Software Lab 5: Applying WCAG 2.1 headings, alt-text descriptions, and accessible PDF tagging.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Document Accessibility (WCAG Standards): Documents must be accessible to everyone, including people using screen-reading software or screen magnifiers. Merely making text bigger and bold does not make it a real heading.

Why Styles Matter: Applying true Heading Styles (Heading 1, Heading 2, Heading 3) lets screen readers jump directly between chapters and lets Word build an automatic Table of Contents with correct page numbers in one click.

Descriptive Alt-Text: Every image, logo, and chart must have a clear 1-sentence Alt-Text description so visually impaired readers understand what is displayed.

Standard Operating Checklist: Document Accessibility

1. Semantic Hierarchy:	Apply Heading 1 for document titles, Heading 2 for major chapters, Heading 3 for subsections.
2. Visual Accessibility:	Ensure minimum text contrast ratio of 4.5:1. Never convey meaning through color alone.
3. Alternative Text (Alt-Text):	Provide concise descriptions of functional images, charts, and diagrams for screen readers.

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB5

LAB5 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are standardizing a 12-page unformatted draft of the company Employee Health & Safety Handbook.

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Reorganize the provided raw text outline into a semantic Heading 1 → Heading 2 → Heading 3 hierarchy.
2. Write appropriate, descriptive Alt-Text for an infographic showing workplace emergency evacuation routes.
3. Describe the 3 checks required before exporting the document as an accessible, tagged PDF/A file.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 1: THEORY & SOP

LAB6

Lab 6: Online Research, Source Reliability & Copyright Compliance



Software Lab 6: Applying the CRAAP test, cross-verifying citations, and Creative Commons licensing.

Workplace Technical Architecture & Governance

Fact-Checking Online Information: The internet contains enormous amounts of useful information alongside outdated guides, biased adverts, and outright misinformation. Always evaluate websites using the **CRAAP test** (Currency, Relevance, Authority, Accuracy, Purpose).

Understanding Copyright: Under the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988, text and photos found on Google Images belong to their creators. You cannot copy images into company brochures without permission or a commercial license.

Creative Commons (CC): Free legal licenses that let creators share their work with the public. For example, **CC-BY** means you can use the image as long as you give credit (attribution) to the original creator.

Standard Operating Checklist: Information Verification

1. Currency & Authority Audit:	Verify publication date and author credentials (peer-reviewed, government statistical agency, or recognized trade body).
2. Cross-Verification Rule:	Never cite a critical statistic without confirming it across at least two independent primary sources.
3. Licensing Compliance:	Verify Creative Commons licenses (CC-BY, CC-SA). Avoid CC-NC assets in commercial business publications.

ADVANCED DIGITAL SOFTWARE LAB • PART 2: HANDS-ON LAB

LAB6

LAB6 • Applied Workplace Hands-On Task

Applied Workplace Scenario & Lab Task

Scenario: You are conducting market research to advise executive directors on choosing an commercial cloud telephone system (VoIP).

Required Lab Deliverables:

1. Apply the 5 criteria of the CRAAP test to evaluate a vendor promotional white paper vs a consumer watchdog report.
2. Explain the legal restrictions of using a 'Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial (CC BY-NC)' image in a commercial company brochure.
3. Compile an annotated corporate research brief comparing two verified telecom providers.

✎ Candidate Command Steps & Technical Implementation Log

Software Lab Sign-Off & Competency Endorsement

Lab Task Completed: [ ] Yes [ ] In Progress

Lead Tutor Verification: Abdul • _____

IT.REF1

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

Workplace File Format & Extension Directory



Technical Reference 1: Corporate file extensions, compression formats, and executable security.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Extension	Category	Associated Software	Security & Everyday Use Notes
.pdf	Document	Adobe Acrobat / Edge	Preserves formatting on all screens; read-only default for final reports.
.docx / .odt	Word Processing	Word / Google Docs	Standard editable documents. Never open untrusted files with macros.
.xlsx / .csv	Spreadsheet	Excel / Google Sheets	.csv is plain text numbers; .xlsx supports formulas, formatting, and charts.
.png / .jpg	Image / Photo	Photos / Browser	.png supports transparent backgrounds; .jpg is standard for photographs.
.zip	Compressed Folder	File Explorer / WinZip	Bundles multiple files together into a smaller file size for easy emailing.
.exe / .bat	Executable Code	Windows Core	Runs programs directly. **Extreme danger in email attachments!**

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

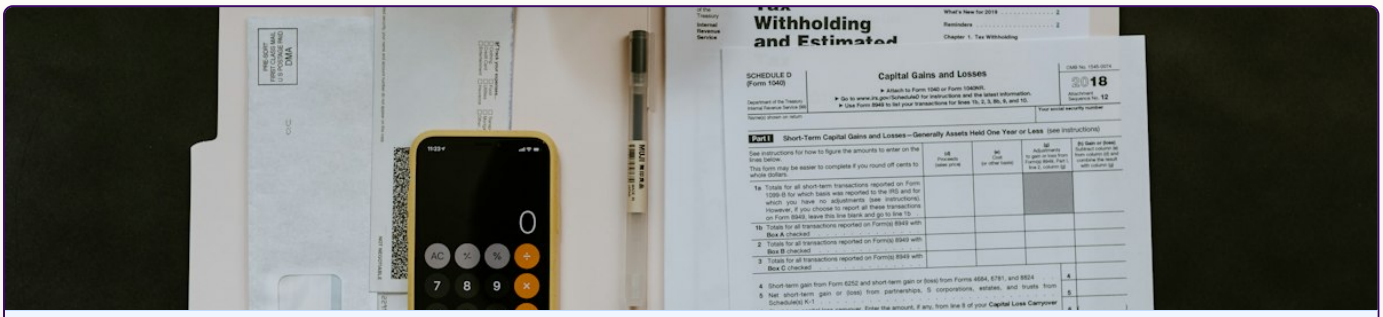
Golden Rule: Never double-click an executable attachment (.exe, .scr, .vbs) received via email, even if the sender appears familiar!

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

IT.REF2

Spreadsheet Error Diagnostics & Function Syntax



Technical Reference 2: Diagnosing and correcting #VALUE!, #REF!, #DIV/0!, and formula syntax errors.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Error Code	Root Cause	Plain English Fix
#DIV/0!	Dividing by zero or an empty cell.	Wrap formula in `=IF(B2=0, 0, A2/B2)` or verify divisor cell has a number.
#VALUE!	Mathematical formula applied to text.	Check that referenced cells contain only digits, not letters or typed symbols.
#REF!	A cell referenced in the formula was deleted.	Undo deletion (`Ctrl + Z`) or retype the formula with the correct cell.
#NAME?	Misspelled function name (e.g. =AVRAGE).	Check function spelling: `=AVERAGE()`, `=SUM()`, `=COUNT()`.
#####	Column width is too narrow for the number.	Double-click the column boundary line at the top to widen the column.

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

Pro-Tip: Always use the Formula Auditing toolbar (Trace Precedents / Trace Dependents) to visualize how formulas link across large workbooks.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

IT.REF3

Cybersecurity Incident Escalation & GDPR Action Flowchart



Technical Reference 3: Statutory 72-hour ICO data breach reporting and forensic containment procedures.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Phase 1 • Immediate Containment (Minutes 0–15):
• Disconnect device from Wi-Fi or unplug the network cable immediately.
• Do NOT turn off the computer (turning it off erases memory clues that IT investigators need).
• Alert your line manager and the designated IT Security / Data Protection Officer.

Phase 2 • Investigation & Triage (Hours 1–24):
• Identify what data was exposed: Does it contain sensitive personal data (medical notes, bank details)?
• Check login logs to see how far the breach reached.

Phase 3 • Statutory Regulatory Disclosure (Within 72 Hours):
• Under UK GDPR, high-risk personal data breaches must be reported to the **Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) within 72 hours**.
• Notify affected customers or patients without delay if their rights and privacy are at risk.

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

Legal Mandate: Fines for non-reporting under UK GDPR can reach £17.5 million or 4% of global annual turnover, whichever is greater.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

IT.REF4

STATUTORY STANDARDS & WORKPLACE IT FRAMEWORK

Workplace Digital Hygiene & Device Ergonomics Audit



Technical Reference 4: 20-20-20 visual rest rule, ergonomic workstation posture, and password security.

Workplace Technical Specification & Architecture

Digital Security Hygiene Checklist:

[ ] Passphrases consist of three random, memorable words (minimum 14 characters).
[ ] Multi-factor authentication (MFA) enabled on email, cloud drives, and internal portals.
[ ] Lock workstation screen (`Win + L`) whenever stepping away from desk.
[ ] Automatic software updates and anti-virus definitions set to auto-install overnight.
[ ] Work files saved exclusively on encrypted cloud backup drives, never on local desktop.

Health & Safety DSE Ergonomic Checklist:

[ ] Top of computer monitor positioned at eye level; distance 50–70 cm from face.
[ ] Forearms rest horizontal to desk surface; wrists remain straight during typing.
[ ] Lumbar spine supported by adjustable ergonomic backrest; feet flat on floor or footrest.
[ ] **20-20-20 rule implemented:** Every 20 minutes, look at an object 20 feet away for 20 seconds.

Core Professional Compliance Mandate

Lead Instructor Endorsement: Maintaining daily digital hygiene and physical ergonomics ensures long-term career productivity and regulatory compliance.

✎ Personal Implementation Notes & Enterprise Protocols

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY

Complete Practical Workflow Solutions & Statutory Guidance

UNIT 1 • FILE ORGANISATION & CLOUD STORAGE SOLUTION

Folder Architecture: `Documents / Clinic_Records / 01_Patient_Feedback / 2026-10-25_Feedback_Survey_v1.docx`.
Standard Naming Rule: Use clear topics, ISO dates (`YYYY-MM-DD`), and version numbers (v1, v2). Never use vague names like 'doc1'.
Desktop Risk: Saving files on the desktop clutters the computer, risks accidental deletion, and prevents colleagues from accessing files.
Cloud Benefit: Saving to cloud drives (OneDrive, Google Drive) backs up files automatically and syncs work across all your devices.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (.pdf) • 2: B (Version 2) • 3: B (Backed up safely online and accessible anywhere).

UNIT 2 • SEARCH OPERATORS & INFORMATION VERIFICATION SOLUTION

Search Operators: Use quotation marks for exact phrases (`"apprenticeship minimum wage rates"`) and domain filters (`site:.gov.uk`).
Trustworthy Domain: Official UK government websites strictly end in `.gov.uk`. Commercial websites (`.com`) often contain advertising.
Spotting Misinformation: Check who wrote the article (Authority), check the date (Currency), look for evidence/citations, and verify with two independent sources.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (Exact phrase search) • 2: B (.gov.uk) • 3: B (Currency / up to date).

UNIT 3 • WORD PROCESSING, STYLES & ACCESSIBILITY SOLUTION

Typography: Use clean sans-serif fonts (Arial, Calibri, or Lexend at 11pt/12pt) with 1.15 line spacing and left alignment.
Styles Benefit: Built-in Heading Styles (Heading 1, Heading 2) ensure consistent styling, allow screen readers to navigate, and create automatic Tables of Contents.
Alt-Text Example: *'Green and white emergency fire exit sign with an arrow pointing right towards the main clinic exit door.'*
Page Breaks: Always use `Ctrl + Enter` to start a new page cleanly without pressing Enter repeatedly.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (Ctrl + Enter) • 2: B (Even spacing for readability) • 3: B (Screen reader image description).

UNIT 4 • SPREADSHEET FORMULAS & CELL REFERENCING SOLUTION

Row Calculation: Subtotal formula in cell D2: `=B2*C2` (multiplies quantity by price).
Absolute Reference: VAT formula: `=D2*$H$1` (the dollar signs lock cell H1 so the tax rate does not shift when dragged down).
Summary Functions: Grand total: `=SUM(D2:D13)` • Average price: `=AVERAGE(C2:C13)`.
Formatting: Highlight cells and click **Currency (£)** on the ribbon to display two decimal places (e.g. £14.50). Never type £ inside a calculation cell.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (= sign) • 2: B (=AVERAGE) • 3: B (Locks cell coordinate as absolute reference).

UNIT 5 • PRESENTATION DESIGN & MULTIMEDIA SOLUTION

Slide Layout (6x6 Rule): Maximum 6 bullet points per slide, with roughly 6 words per bullet point so slides remain clean and easy to read.
Accessibility Choices: High contrast (navy/black text on light background), 24pt+ font size, descriptive Alt-Text on images, and closed captions on videos.
Presenter View: Use Presenter View so your speaker notes appear on your private screen while the audience sees only the slides on the projector.
Transitions: Use simple 'Fade' transitions; avoid distracting spinning animations or loud sound effects.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (6 bullets with 6 words) • 2: B (Low contrast / hard to read) • 3: B (View notes privately while presenting).

UNIT 6 • PROFESSIONAL EMAIL ETIQUETTE & BCC SOLUTION

Email Layout: Clear subject line (`Course Confirmation: Adult Digital Skills Induction – 12 Nov`), polite greeting, concise bulleted body, and professional sign-off.
BCC Privacy Rule: When emailing 35 students, their email addresses **must be placed in BCC (Blind Carbon Copy)** so they cannot see each other's details.
UK GDPR Compliance: Revealing private customer or student email addresses without consent in 'To' or 'CC' is an unlawful personal data breach.
Attachment Hygiene: Compress large attachments or send secure cloud links; keep attachments under 10 MB.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: C (BCC hides recipient addresses) • 2: B (Interpreted as shouting / rude) • 3: C (Concise summary of topic and deadline).

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

UNIT 7 • VIDEO CONFERENCING & ONLINE MEETINGS SOLUTION

Pre-Meeting Setup: Test microphone and headset audio, check camera framing and lighting, and turn on Background Blur to keep home life private.
Screen Sharing Privacy: Choose **Share Window** (only your specific document) instead of Share Entire Screen to prevent accidental display of personal emails.
Meeting Etiquette: Keep microphone muted when not speaking to eliminate background noise; use the digital 'Raise Hand' button to ask questions.
Chat Etiquette: Use the in-meeting chat box to post helpful links or type comments without interrupting the speaker.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (Eliminate background noise) • 2: B (Prevents private desktop notifications from being seen) • 3: B (Background Blur).

UNIT 8 • E-COMMERCE NAVIGATION & SECURE PAYMENTS SOLUTION

Security Checks: (1) Web address begins with `https://`; (2) Locked padlock symbol in address bar; (3) Verified UK physical address and phone number; (4) Clear return policy and positive reviews.
Padlock Meaning: The connection is encrypted with SSL/TLS security so bank card details cannot be intercepted by hackers.
Strong Customer Authentication (3D Secure): Two-step bank verification (SMS code or banking app approval) before money leaves your account.
Order Confirmation: Always save the order confirmation screen and download the PDF receipt with the reference code for accounting records.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (Secure encrypted connection) • 2: B (Bank verifies transaction via app/SMS) • 3: B (Does not reveal card numbers to seller).

UNIT 9 • PUBLIC DIGITAL SERVICES & GOV.UK PORTALS SOLUTION

Official Domain: Official UK government services strictly end in `.gov.uk`; official NHS services end in `.nhs.uk`.
Avoiding Copycat Scams: Never use commercial third-party websites that charge £30–£80 'admin fees' for services that are free or standard price on GOV.UK.
Form Completion: Fill in mandatory fields marked with a red asterisk (*); correct data formatting errors highlighted in red (e.g. postcode spacing).
Document Uploads: Upload clear, readable photos or PDF scans of required proof-of-identity documents within allowed file size limits (under 5 MB).
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: A (.gov.uk) • 2: B (Mandatory field) • 3: B (Avoid unnecessary third-party handling fees).

UNIT 10 • CYBERSECURITY, PASSWORDS & UK GDPR SOLUTION

Phishing Red Flags: (1) Artificial urgency ('Account suspended tonight!'); (2) Mismatched sender email address; (3) Generic greeting ('Dear Customer'); (4) Suspicious links.
Passphrase Method: Three random, memorable words (e.g. `Purple$Pebble72Blanket!`) creates a strong password that is easy to remember and hard to hack.
Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): Requires password PLUS a temporary code sent to your phone to log in, protecting accounts even if passwords leak.
UK GDPR Rules: Lock computer screens (`Win + L`) when leaving desks; report serious personal data breaches to the ICO within 72 hours.
20-20-20 Rule: Every 20 minutes, look at an object 20 feet away for 20 seconds to prevent eye fatigue.
Knowledge Check Answers: 1: B (Three random words method) • 2: B (Two verification steps to log in) • 3: B (72 hours).

MOCK 1 • MEDICAL PRACTICE ADMINISTRATIVE OPERATIONS SOLUTION (PART 1)

Task 1 (Hierarchy & Storage): Created 3 subfolders: `01_General_Practice`, `02_Phlebotomy`, `03_Physiotherapy`. Named files using ISO format (e.g. `2026-10-25_Patient_Guide_v1.docx`). Storing on secure cloud servers protects confidential data and complies with healthcare governance.
Task 2 (Word Processing): Applied Heading 1 to primary topics, Heading 2 to sub-sections, generated automatic Table of Contents, formatted 4-column appointment schedule table with bold header row, and added descriptive Alt-Text to clinic logo.
Task 3 (Research & CRAAP): Formulated query `"flu vaccine eligibility" site:.nhs.uk`; verified source currency and authority directly from NHS guidance.

MOCK 1 • MEDICAL PRACTICE ADMINISTRATIVE OPERATIONS SOLUTION (PART 2)

Task 4 (Email & BCC): Drafted polite formal invitation; placed all 40 patient email addresses in **BCC** to prevent unlawful disclosure of patient medical contacts under UK GDPR; attached encrypted PDF clinic map.

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

MOCK 2 • COMMUNITY FOOD BANK LOGISTICS & STOCK TRACKING SOLUTION

Task 1 (Spreadsheet Modeling): Line Total formula: `=B4*C4`; Total Weight function: `=SUM(D4:D18)`; Average Weight: `=AVERAGE(D4:D18)`.
Task 2 (Conditional Alerts): Threshold formula in cell G4: `=IF(B4<20, "RESTOCK URGENT", "ADEQUATE")`; formatted numbers with 1 decimal place and currency as £0.00.
Task 3 (Data Visualisation): Generated Clustered Column Chart; added clear title *'Current Food Bank Stock Levels by Category'*; labelled X-axis (Food Category) and Y-axis (Units in Stock); added data labels above bars.
Task 4 (Communication & Versioning): Composed volunteer update using BCC for volunteer privacy; explained how to restore lost data using Cloud Version History (`File → Info → Version History`).

MOCK 3 • APPRENTICE TRAINING HUB & E-LEARNING ADMINISTRATION SOLUTION

Task 1 (Virtual Induction): Scheduled MS Teams meeting; configured Presenter role for tutors and Attendee role for apprentices; wrote clear agenda with video call etiquette (mute when not speaking, background blur on).
Task 2 (Presentation Design): Created 4-slide deck following 6x6 rule; Slide 2 bullet points on passphrases and 2FA; applied high contrast navy text on cream and added Alt-Text.
Task 3 (Phishing Triage): Identified 4 red flags: mismatched sender domain, urgent threat of account cancellation, generic greeting, suspicious hyperlink. Disconnected network cable immediately and logged incident.
Task 4 (GDPR Subject Access Request): Outlined 4 steps: verify apprentice identity, log statutory 1 calendar month deadline, redact third-party data, provide digital copy free of charge.

MOCK 4 • DIGITAL LIBRARY ARCHIVE & ASSET LOAN MANAGEMENT SOLUTION

Task 1 (Equipment Loan Spreadsheet): Used locked reference `=$H$1*E2` to calculate overdue penalty charges; applied Data Validation list (Available, On Loan, Under Repair) to prevent typing errors; formatted totals as Currency (£).
Task 2 (E-Commerce & Payment Security): Verified requirements for online payments: SSL/TLS padlock encryption (HTTPS), 3D Secure customer verification, and compliance with data security standards.
Task 3 (Copyright & Licensing): Explained that commercial reuse of historic photos requires copyright owner permission; Public Domain images can be freely used; Creative Commons (CC-BY) requires attribution of creator.
Task 4 (Ergonomics DSE Audit): Verified monitor at eye level 50–70 cm away, chair lumbar support, wrists horizontal, and implemented the 20-20-20 visual rest rule.

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

UNIVERSAL OPERATING SYSTEM & BROWSER SHORTCUTS (PART 1)

Universal Operating System Shortcuts (Windows / macOS):

- Copy: `Ctrl + C` (Win) / `Cmd + C` (Mac)
- Paste: `Ctrl + V` (Win) / `Cmd + V` (Mac)
- Cut: `Ctrl + X` (Win) / `Cmd + X` (Mac)
- Undo / Redo: `Ctrl + Z` / `Ctrl + Y`
- Select All: `Ctrl + A`
- Find in Document or Page: `Ctrl + F`
- Save Document: `Ctrl + S`
- Print / Save as PDF: `Ctrl + P`

UNIVERSAL OPERATING SYSTEM & BROWSER SHORTCUTS (PART 2)

- Lock Workstation Screen: `Win + L`
- Open File Explorer: `Win + E`
- Task Manager (Force Close Frozen App): `Ctrl + Shift + Esc`

Web Browser Shortcuts (Chrome / Edge / Firefox):

- New Tab: `Ctrl + T` Close Tab: `Ctrl + W`
- Reopen Closed Tab: `Ctrl + Shift + T`
- Private / Incognito Window: `Ctrl + Shift + N`
- Bookmark Current Page: `Ctrl + D`
- Refresh Page: `F5` Hard Refresh (Clear Cache): `Ctrl + F5`

UNIVERSAL OPERATING SYSTEM & BROWSER SHORTCUTS (PART 3)

- Zoom In / Out / Reset: `Ctrl + Plus` / `Ctrl + Minus` / `Ctrl + 0`

Spreadsheet Modeling Shortcuts (Excel / Google Sheets):

- Edit Active Cell: `F2`
- Toggle Absolute Reference ($): `F4` (cycles A1 → A1 → A$1 → $A1)
- AutoSum Selected Range: `Alt + =`
- Insert Current Date: `Ctrl + ;`
- Fill Down / Fill Right: `Ctrl + D` / `Ctrl + R`
- Format as Currency (£): `Ctrl + Shift + 4`

UNIVERSAL OPERATING SYSTEM & BROWSER SHORTCUTS (PART 4)

- Format as Percentage (%): `Ctrl + Shift + 5`

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

DIGITAL SKILLS & CYBERSECURITY GLOSSARY (PART 1)

Absolute Cell Reference (A1)
A locked cell coordinate in a spreadsheet formula using dollar signs ($). It stays fixed on that exact cell when autofilled down a column.

Alt-Text (Alternative Text)
A short written description added to an image or chart. A screen reader reads this aloud to visually impaired readers so they know what the picture displays.

Cloud Storage & Syncing
Saving your files on secure internet servers (like OneDrive, Google Drive, or iCloud). Files update (sync) automatically across all your devices and are safe from loss.

Cybersecurity Hygiene
Everyday security habits that protect your data, such as using strong passphrases, never sharing logins, locking your screen, and running software updates.

Data Protection / UK GDPR
UK law that protects individuals' personal data (names, medical notes, bank details). Organisations must keep data confidential and report breaches within 72 hours.

DSE & Ergonomics
Display Screen Equipment health rules for setting up your desk, chair, and monitor to avoid back, neck, and eye strain, including the 20-20-20 visual rest rule.

DIGITAL SKILLS & CYBERSECURITY GLOSSARY (PART 2)

E-Commerce
Buying, selling, or paying for goods and services over the internet, such as online shopping, booking tickets, or paying bills through secure payment systems.

File Hierarchy & Extensions
Organising files into labelled folders and subfolders. File extensions (.docx, .xlsx, .pdf, .jpg) are codes after the dot that tell computers which software opens the file.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
A security system that requires two steps to log in: your password PLUS a temporary code sent to your phone or app. Keeps accounts safe even if passwords leak.

Netiquette
Polite and respectful rules of digital communication, such as using clear email subject lines, avoiding ALL CAPS (which feels like shouting), and muting on video calls.

DIGITAL SKILLS & CYBERSECURITY GLOSSARY (PART 3)

Phishing
A fake email or text pretending to be from a trusted company (like your bank or Royal Mail) to trick you into clicking a link, downloading a virus, or giving away passwords.

SSL / HTTPS & Padlock
A locked padlock symbol and 'https://' in your browser showing that your connection is encrypted, scrambling your card numbers and passwords so thieves cannot steal them.

Subject Access Request (SAR)
A legal right under UK GDPR allowing any individual to request a free copy of all personal records and data an organisation holds about them within 1 month.

OFFICIAL SOLUTIONS, SHORTCUTS & REFERENCE DIRECTORY (CONTINUED)

DIGITAL SKILLS CURRICULUM INDEX (PART 1)

A

Absolute cell references (A1) 20, 66, 77
Access permissions (View, Comment, Edit) 28, 64
Accessibility tools (Zoom, Screen Reader) 4, 16, 24
Alt-Text for images and diagrams 16, 24, 72

B

Backup strategies (3-2-1 rule) 4, 79
BCC (Blind Carbon Copy) privacy rule 28, 48, 52, 68
Browser shortcuts & navigation 82
Budget spreadsheets & calculations 20, 52, 66

C

Cell references & coordinates (B4) 20, 77
Cloud storage & syncing (OneDrive, Drive) 4, 8, 64
CRAAP test for source evaluation 12, 74
Cybersecurity essentials & passphrases 44, 70, 78

D

Data Protection Act & UK GDPR 44, 78
Data validation dropdown lists 66
Digital footprint & online reputation 44
DSE workstation ergonomics (20-20-20 rule) 44, 79

E

E-Commerce & secure online shopping 36
Email etiquette & professional register 28, 68
Excel / Sheets formulas (=SUM, =AVERAGE) 20, 52, 66, 77
Extensions for files (.pdf, .docx, .xlsx) 8, 76

F

File folder hierarchy & nested folders 8, 48, 64
File naming standards & versions 8, 48
Fire exit alt-text & diagrams 16, 72
Formulas vs built-in functions 20, 77

G

GOV.UK official public services 40
Green checkmark cloud sync icon 8, 64

H

Hardware input & output peripherals 4
Heading styles (Heading 1, Heading 2) 16, 72
HTTPS & SSL padlock encryption 36, 78

I

IF statements & logical conditions 20, 52, 66
Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) 44, 78
Input devices vs Output devices 4

M

Margins & page setup (2.54 cm) 16, 72
Mocks 1-4 workplace scenarios 48-63
Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA / 2FA) 44, 78, 79

DIGITAL SKILLS CURRICULUM INDEX (PART 2)

N

Netiquette & online communication 28, 32, 68
NHS App & public healthcare portals 40, 48

O

Operating Systems (Windows, macOS, ChromeOS) 4, 8
Order verification & digital receipts 36

P

Page Breaks (Ctrl + Enter) 16, 72
Passphrases (three random words method) 44, 79
Phishing detection & red flags 44, 70
Presenter View in slide presentations 24

Q

Quotation marks in search queries 12, 74

R

Relative vs absolute cell references 20, 66
Reply All warnings & etiquette 28, 68
Restoring older versions (Version History) 64

S

Search operators ("...", -, site:.gov.uk) 12, 74
Shortcuts matrix (OS, Browser, Sheets) 82
Six-by-six rule for clean slides 24
Solutions for Units 1-10 Drills 80-81
Solutions for Mocks 1-4 81

T

Tables formatting & header rows 16, 20
To vs CC vs BCC address fields 28, 68
Transitions & animations on slides 24
Troubleshooting spreadsheet errors (#VALUE!, #REF!) 77

U

Units 1-10 comprehensive study guides 8-47

V

Version control in cloud documents 8, 64
Video conferencing etiquette & muting 32
Virtual backgrounds & background blur 32

W

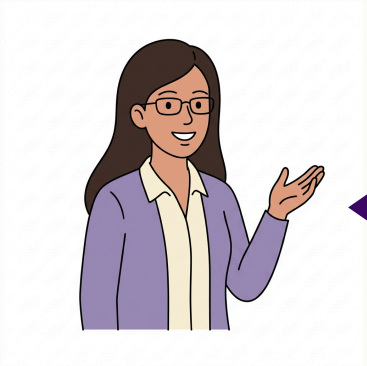
Window sharing vs entire desktop sharing 32
Word processing professional layout 16, 72
Workstation setup & posture 44, 79

NATIONAL STANDARDS MASTERY AUDIT

CP Digital Skills Competency Passport

Statutory Digital Competency Verification

Domain	Level	Assessment Mode	Status	Date
1. Using Devices & Handling Info	Level 1/2	Folder Structure Task	[ ] Competent	
2. Creating & Editing	Level 1/2	Spreadsheet & Chart	[ ] Competent	
3. Communicating	Level 1/2	Formal Email & Calendar	[ ] Competent	
4. Transacting	Level 1/2	E-Commerce & Form Data	[ ] Competent	
5. Being Safe & Responsible	Level 1/2	Security & GDPR Audit	[ ] Competent	



Priya

Retain this signed passport in your professional portfolio as evidence of digital literacy for employers and apprenticeship standards.

✎ Personal Professional Development Targets

CERT

NATIONAL CURRICULUM MILESTONE SIGN-OFF

Certificate of Digital Competence



Accredited milestone: Mastering national digital standards for lifelong career advancement.

Master Functional Skills • Certificate of Digital Competence

This certifies that

_____

has completed the Essential Digital Skills National Curriculum and successfully passed all 4 synoptic workplace scenario examinations.

Lead Instructor: Abdul

Practical Exam Score: _____ / 50

Date Verified: _____

Exam Centre: Master Functional Skills

✎ Final Examination Tips & Digital Safety Reminders

Master essential digital skills for work, study, and daily life

Mapped directly to the Department for Education (DfE) National Standards for Essential Digital Skills. Features visual, screenshot-guided instructions for navigating devices, operating cloud systems, communicating professionally, and staying secure online.

INSIDE THIS PUBLICATION

- ✔ **All 5 National Digital Standards:** Using Devices & Handling Information, Creating & Editing, Communicating, Transacting, and Being Safe Online.
- ✔ **Hands-On Workplace Practicality:** File management, spreadsheets, formatting documents, email attachments, and online collaboration tools.
- ✔ **Cybersecurity & Online Safety:** Recognizing phishing emails, password hygiene, two-factor authentication, and data privacy rights.
- ✔ **Digital Transaction Protocols:** Booking appointments, online banking safely, evaluating credible web sources, and public services.
- ✔ **Authentic Practical Assessment Tasks:** Simulated exam scenarios calibrated to Gateway, Pearson, and NCFE EDSQ standards.

Official EDSQ Curriculum Alignment:

Aligned with the statutory National Standards for Essential Digital Skills at Entry Level 3 and Level 1. Ideal for college courses, adult education, and corporate digital literacy programs.

Master Functional Skills Publishing
Approved Assessment Support Materials • Great Britain
Registered Office: Oxford • London • United Kingdom

978-1-912345-86-9